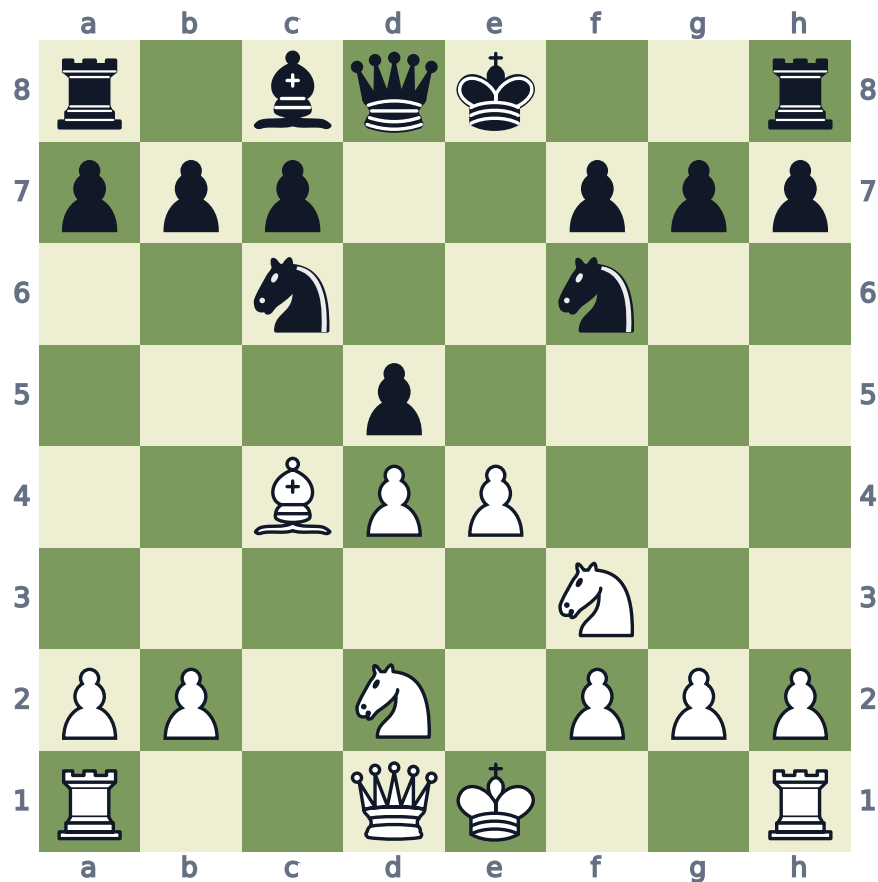


What Did the Last Move Change?

Board updates, opened lines, abandoned duties, and new threats



Train the update skill that prevents many blunders: compare the position before and after a move and identify every important geometric and strategic consequence.

36 practice units | separated solutions | scoring | review plan

ORIENTATION

How to get real improvement from this course

PURPOSE

Train the update skill that prevents many blunders: compare the position before and after a move and identify every important geometric and strategic consequence.

TRAINING RULES

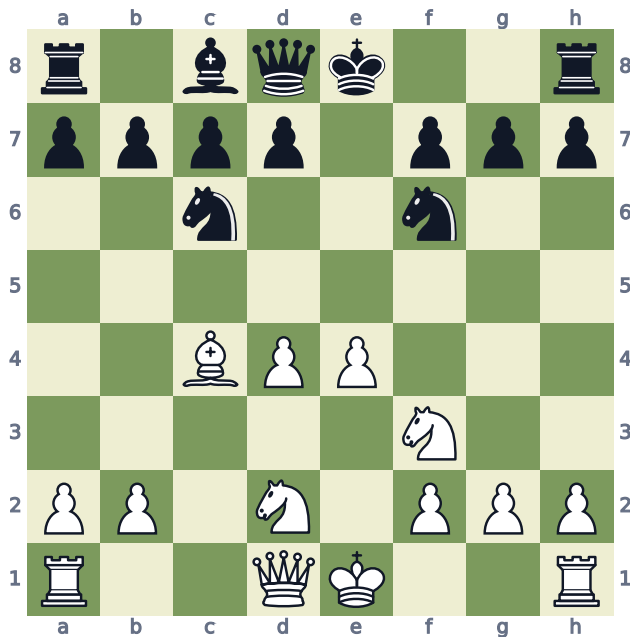
- Compare the two diagrams before reading the move notation.
- Name the moved piece, vacated square, new attacks, abandoned duties, and changed lines.
- Treat pawn moves, captures, checks, and defender moves as high-priority updates.
- Finish by asking what the opponent now threatens and what the move may have weakened.
-

COURSE SIZE

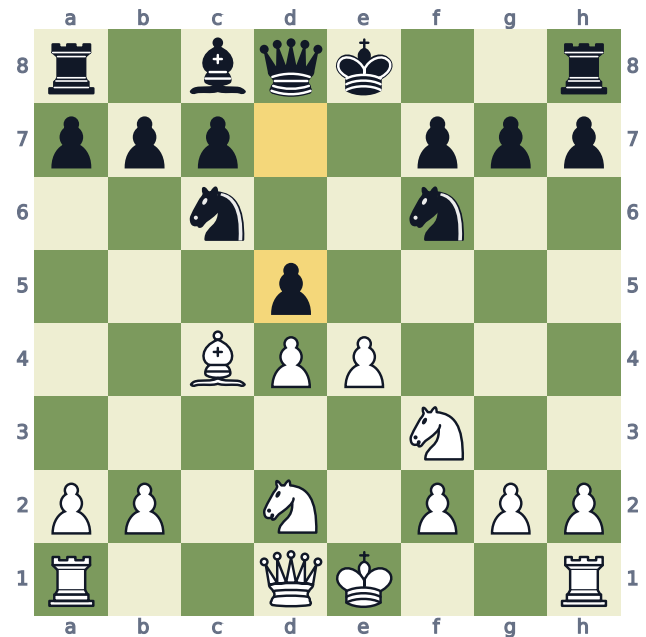
This PDF contains 36 practice units. Problems appear before their solutions whenever practical. Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days.

COMPARISON 01 OF 36

Italian Game



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

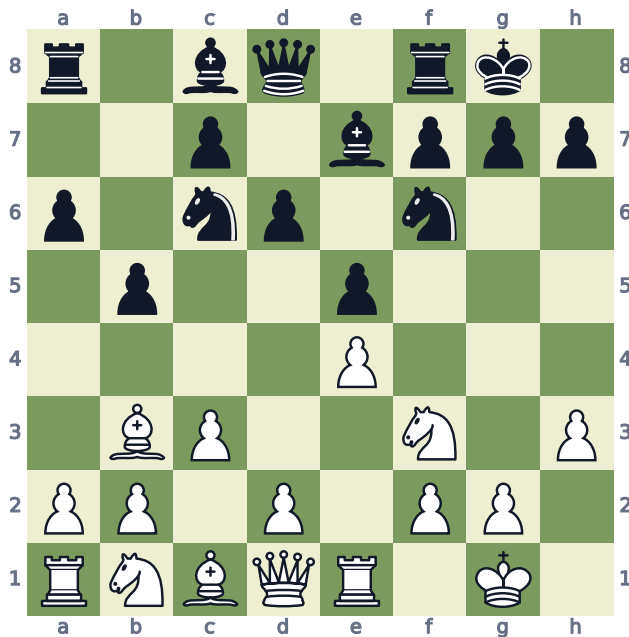
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

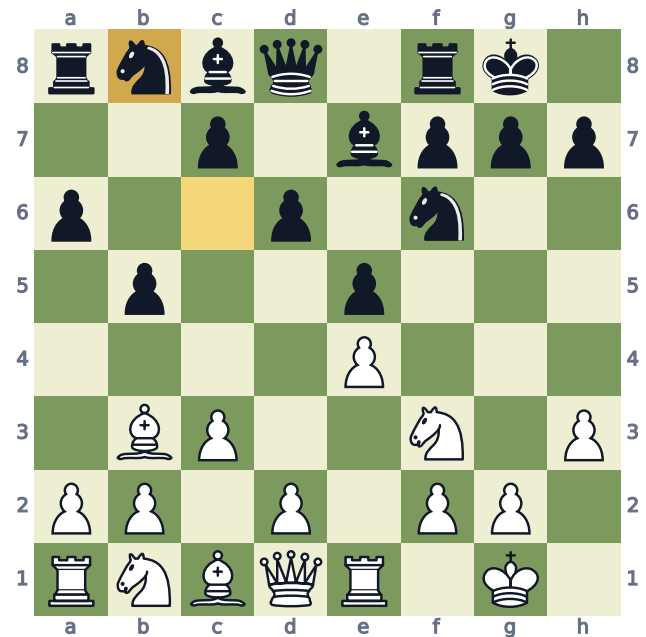
1. cxd4 Bb4+ 2. Bd2 Bxd2+ 3. Nbx d2 d5

COMPARISON 02 OF 36

Ruy Lopez



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

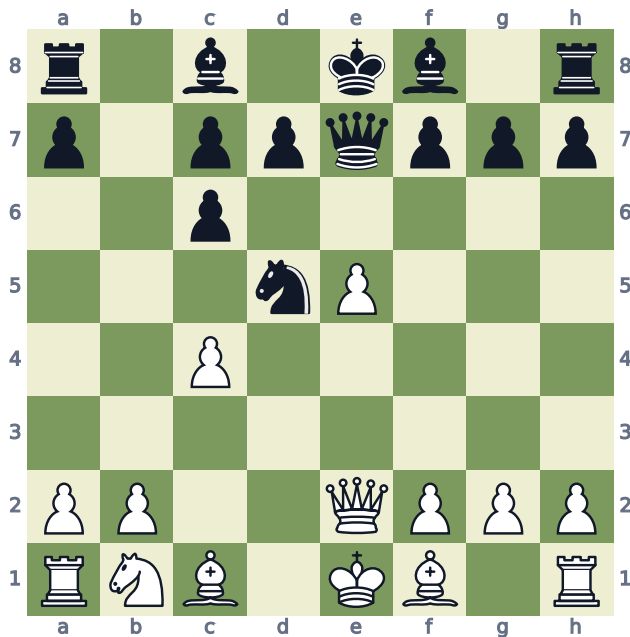
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

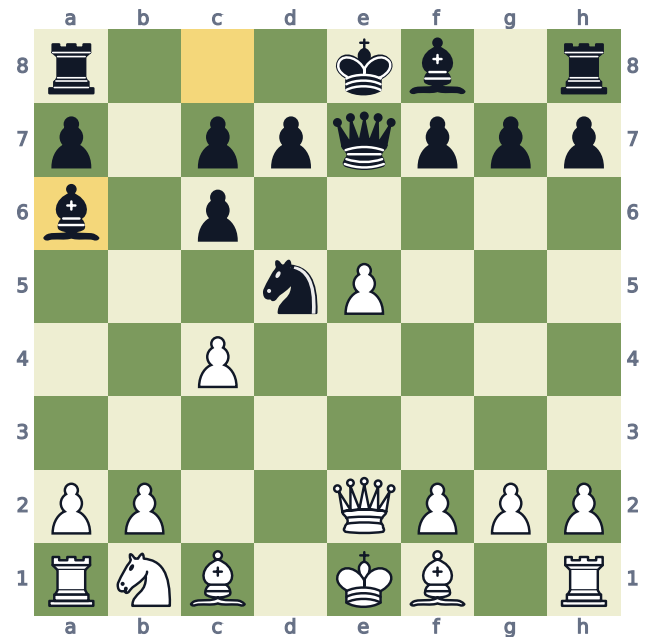
1. Bb3 d6 2. c3 O-O 3. h3 Nb8

COMPARISON 03 OF 36

Scotch Game



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

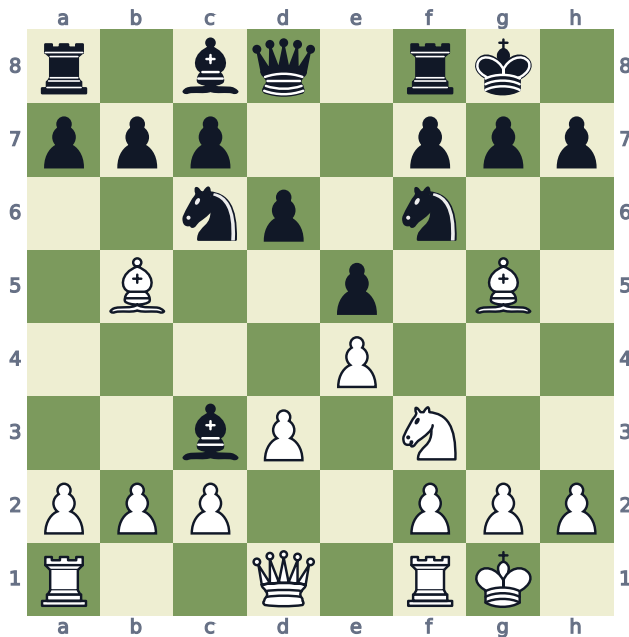
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

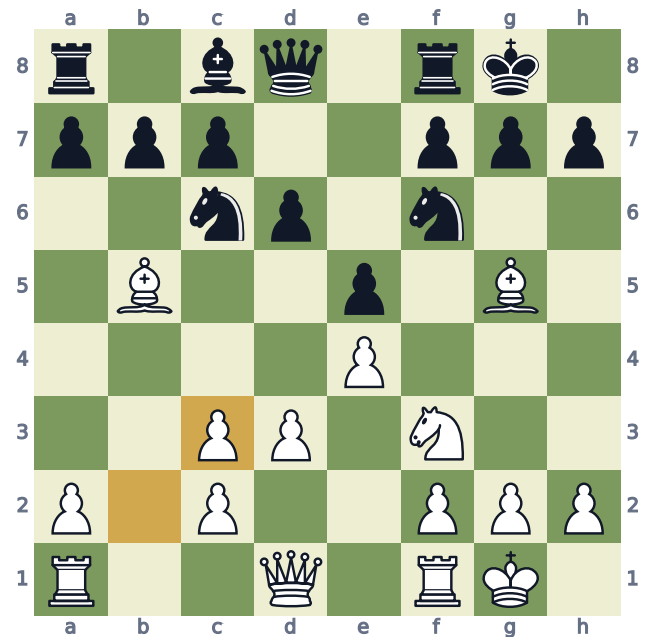
1. e5 Qe7 2. Qe2 Nd5 3. c4 Ba6

COMPARISON 04 OF 36

Four Knights Game



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

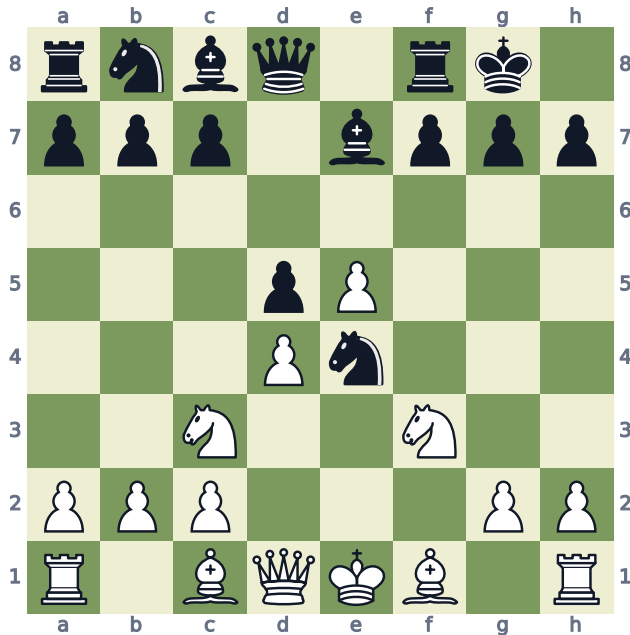
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

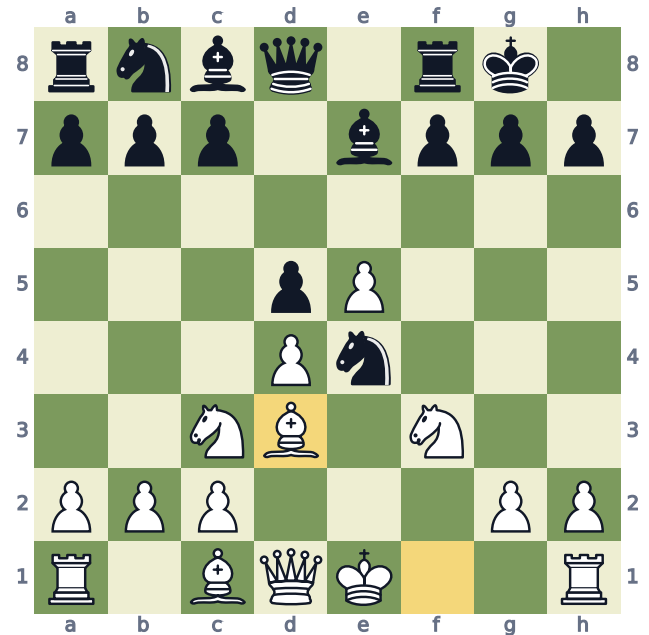
1. O-O d3 2. d6 Bg5 3. Bxc3 bxc3

COMPARISON 05 OF 36

Vienna Game



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

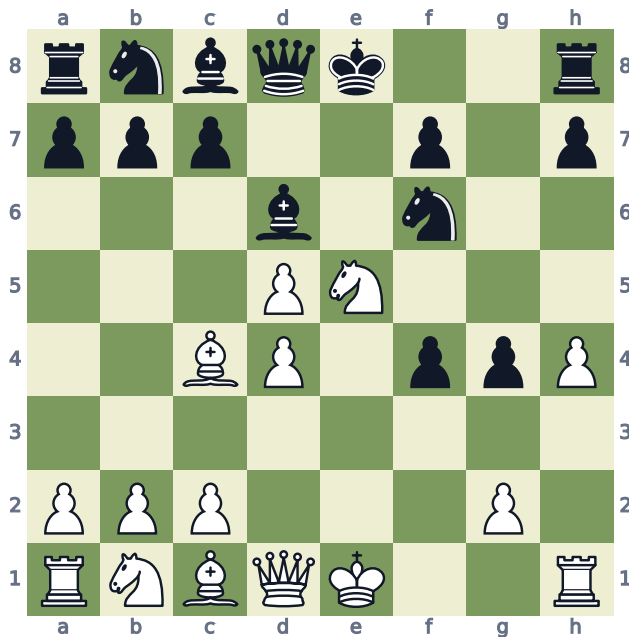
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

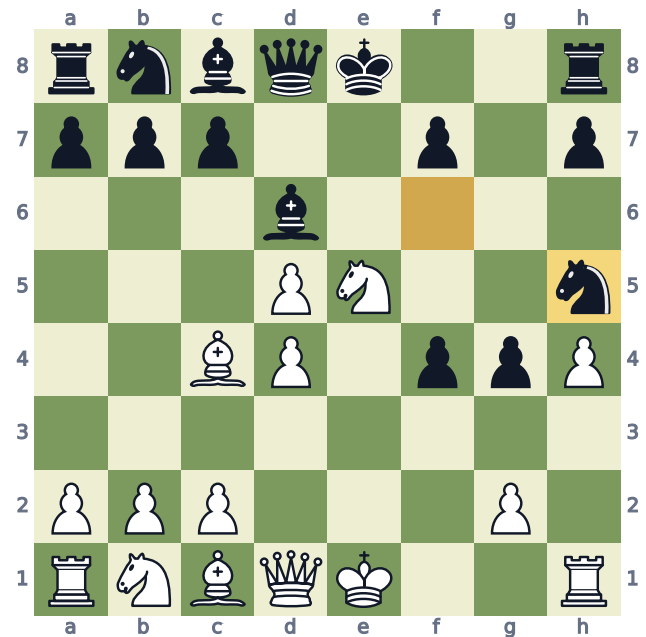
1. Nxe4 Nf3 2. Be7 d4 3. O-O Bd3

COMPARISON 06 OF 36

King's Gambit



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

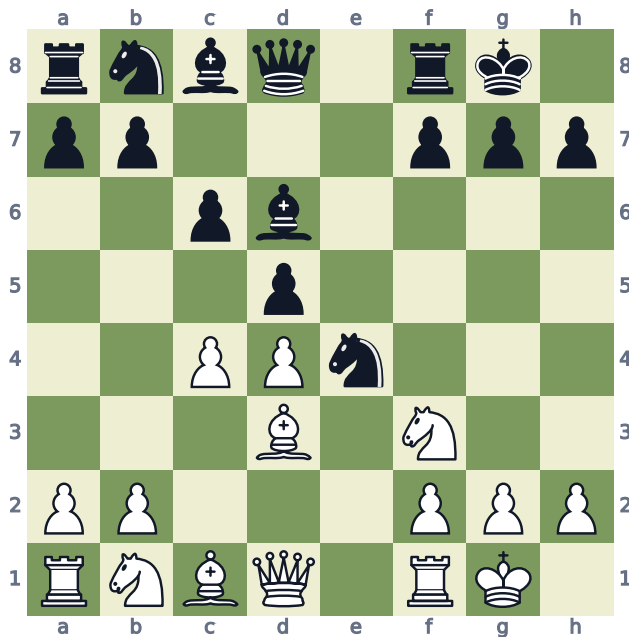
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

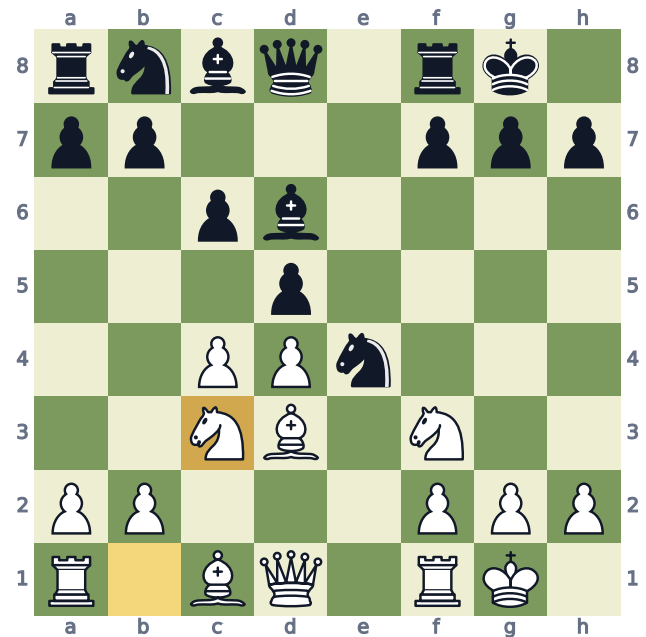
1. Bc4 d5 2. exd5 Bd6 3. d4 Nh5

COMPARISON 07 OF 36

Petrov Defense



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

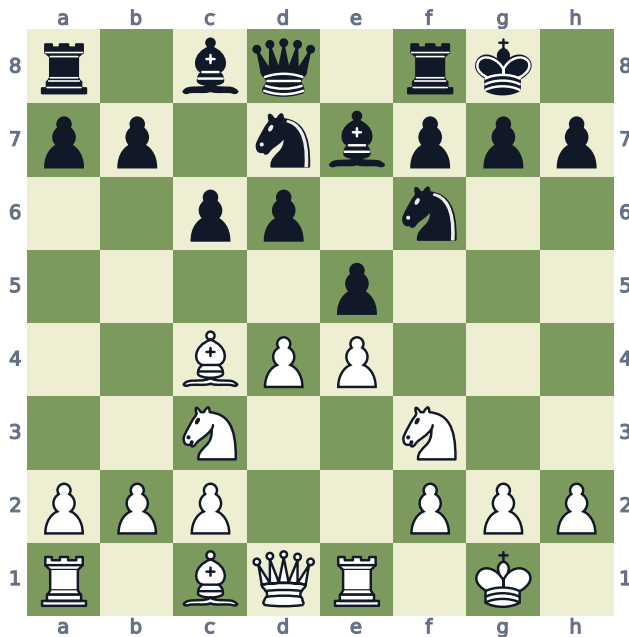
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

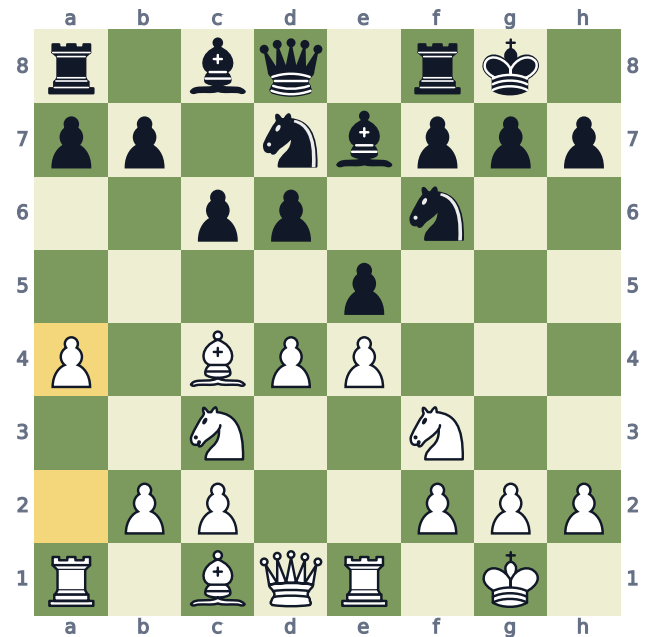
1. Bd6 O-O 2. O-O c4 3. c6 Nc3

COMPARISON 08 OF 36

Philidor Defense



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

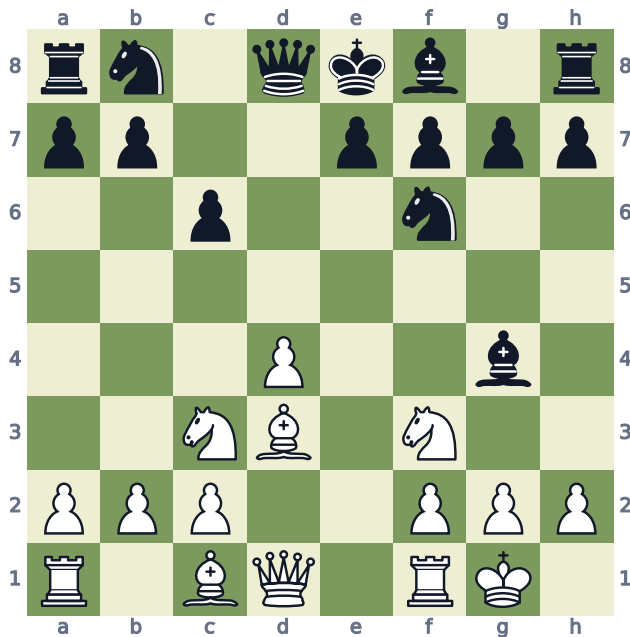
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

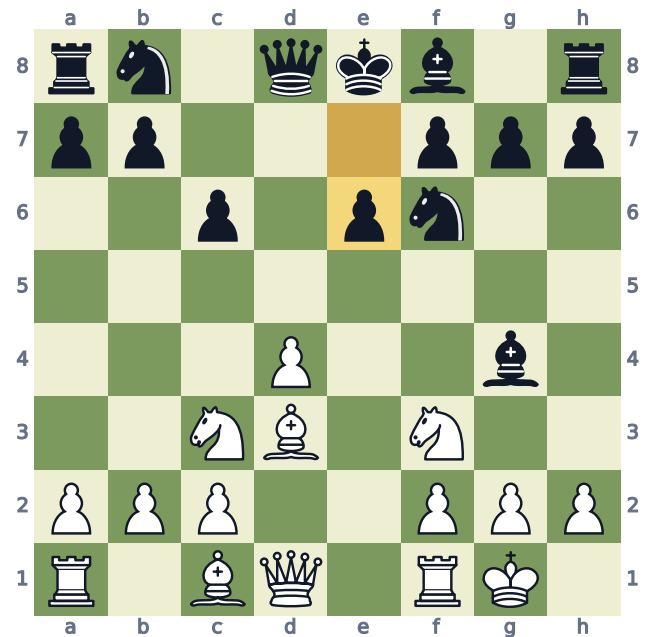
1. Be7 O-O 2. O-O Re1 3. c6 a4

COMPARISON 09 OF 36

Scandinavian Defense



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

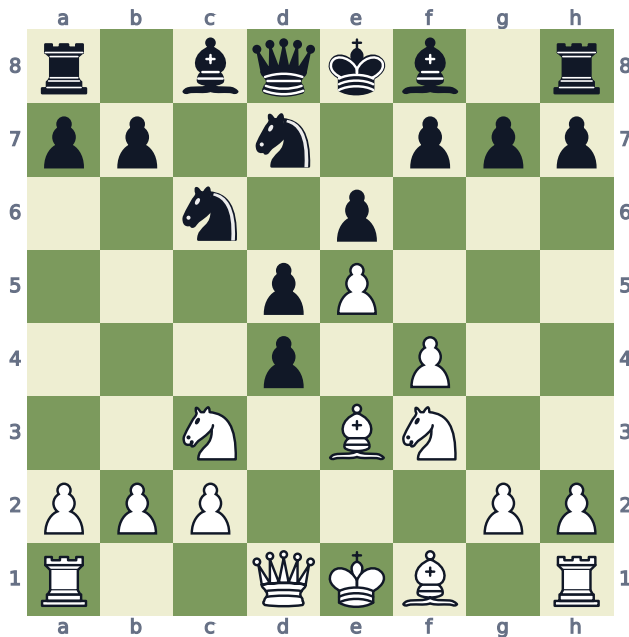
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

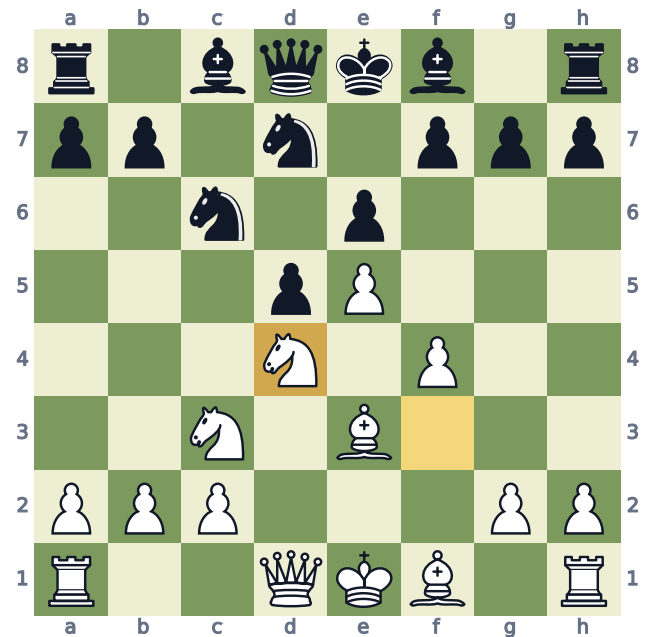
1. Nf3 c6 2. Bd3 Bg4 3. O-O e6

COMPARISON 10 OF 36

French Defense



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

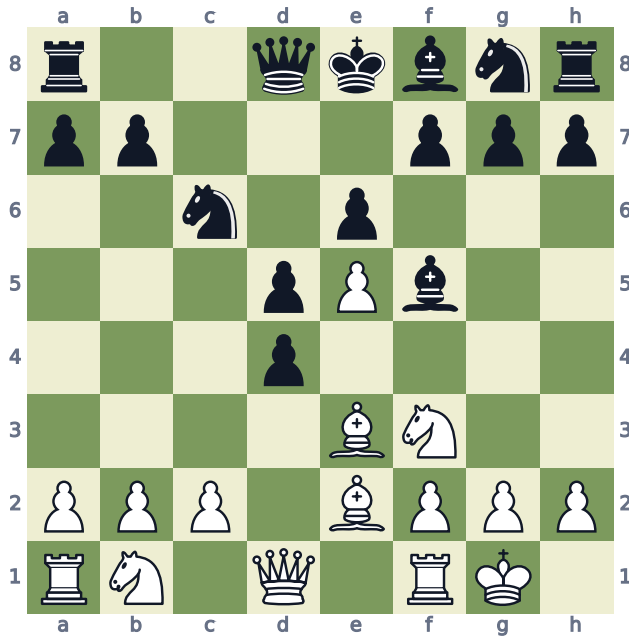
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

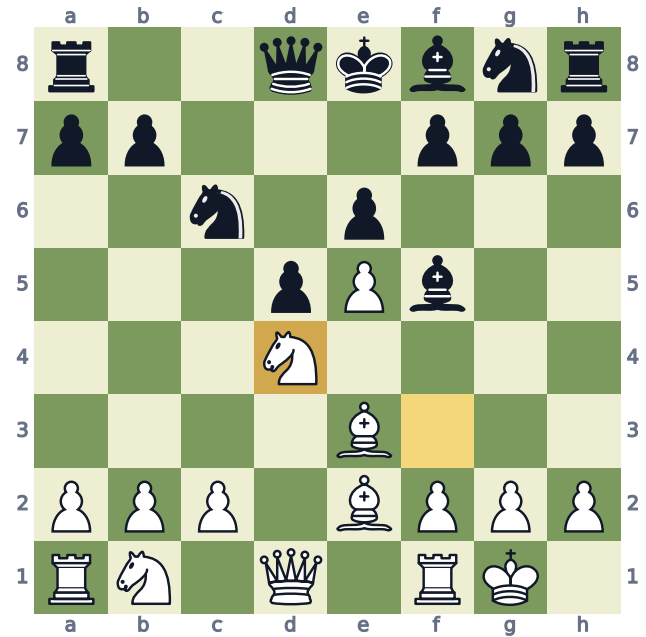
1. c5 Nf3 2. Nc6 Be3 3. cxd4 Nxd4

COMPARISON 11 OF 36

Caro-Kann Defense



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

1. c5 O-O 2. Nc6 Be3 3. cxd4 Nxd4

Open Sicilian

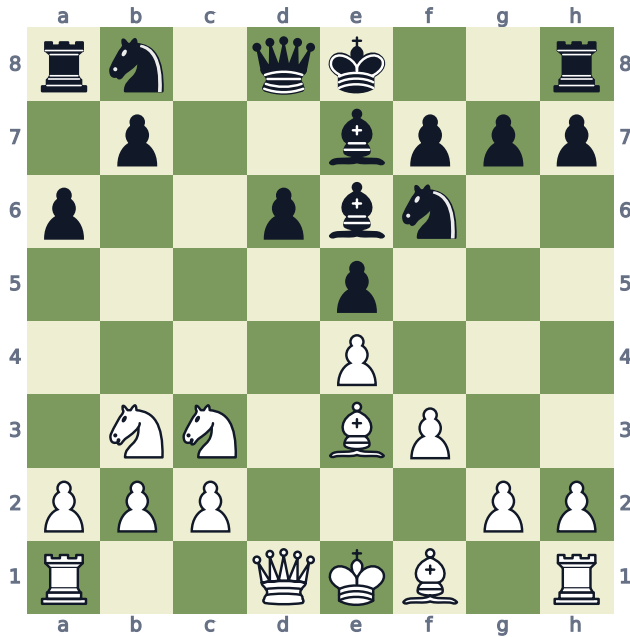


Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

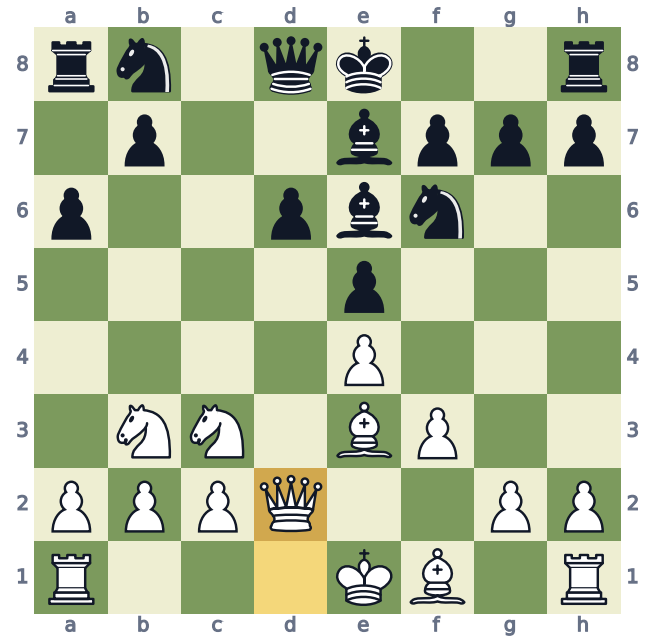
1. Nc6 Be3 2. e6 Qd2 3. Be7 O-O-O

COMPARISON 13 OF 36

Sicilian Najdorf



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

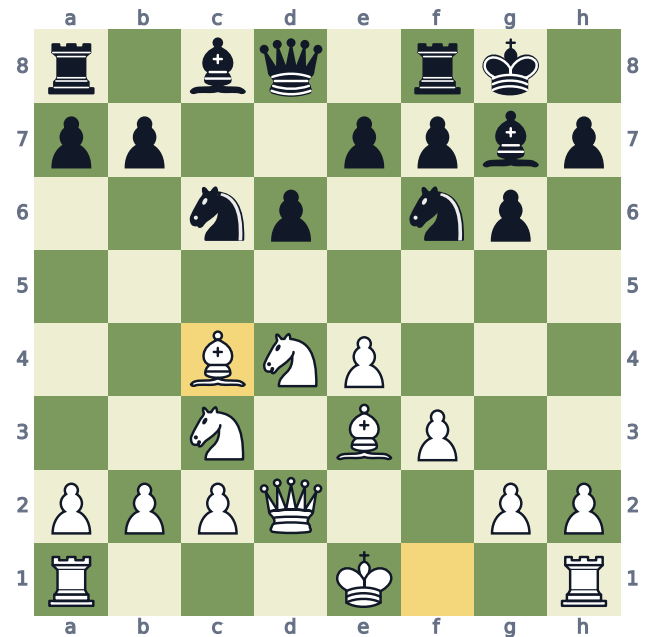
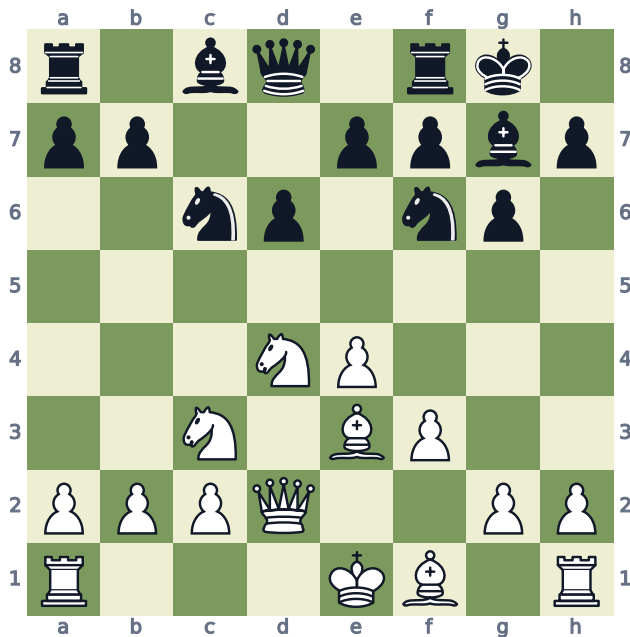
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

1. e5 Nb3 2. Be6 f3 3. Be7 Qd2

COMPARISON 14 OF 36

Sicilian Dragon



YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

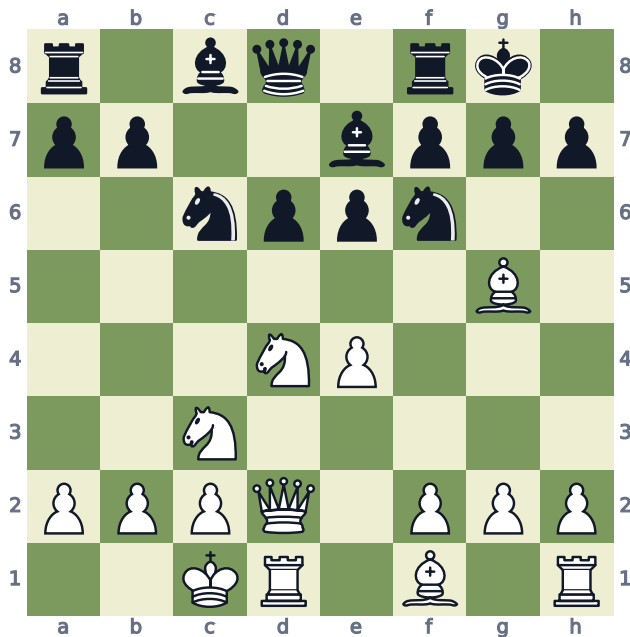
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

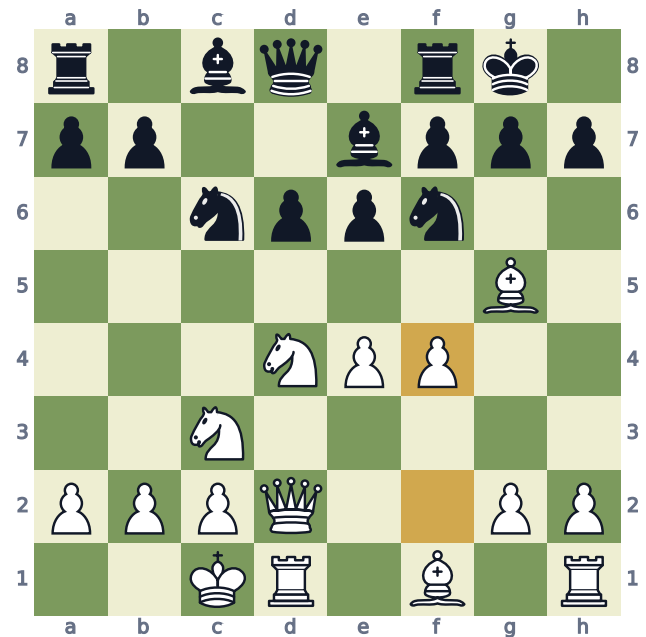
1. Bg7 f3 2. O-O Qd2 3. Nc6 Bc4

COMPARISON 15 OF 36

Classical Sicilian



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

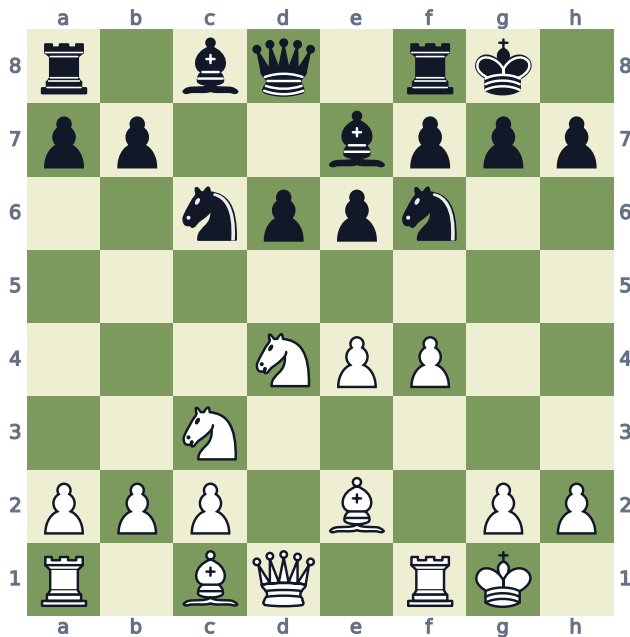
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

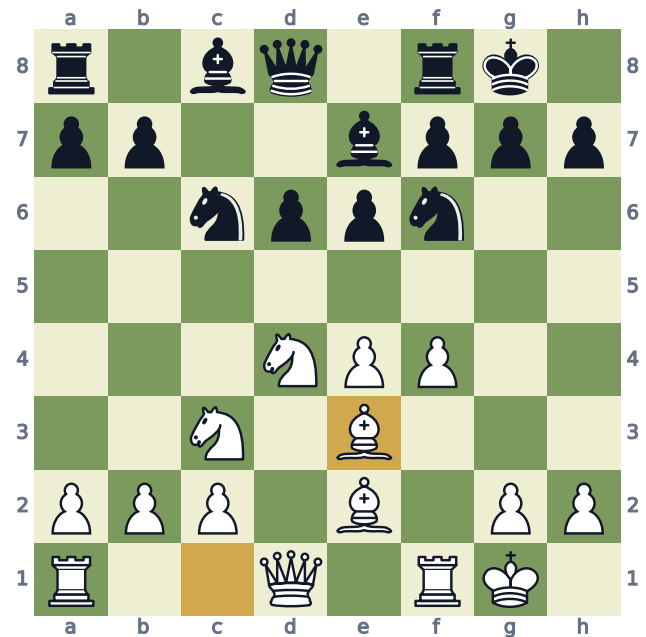
1. e6 Qd2 2. Be7 O-O-O 3. O-O f4

COMPARISON 16 OF 36

Sicilian Scheveningen



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

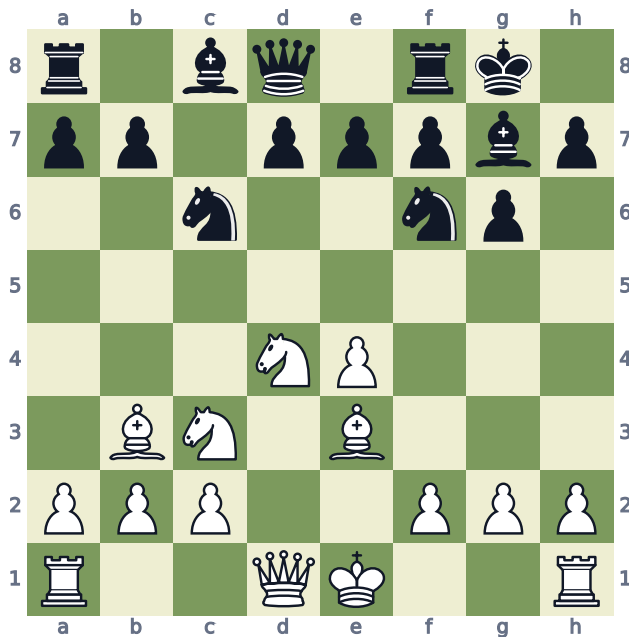
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

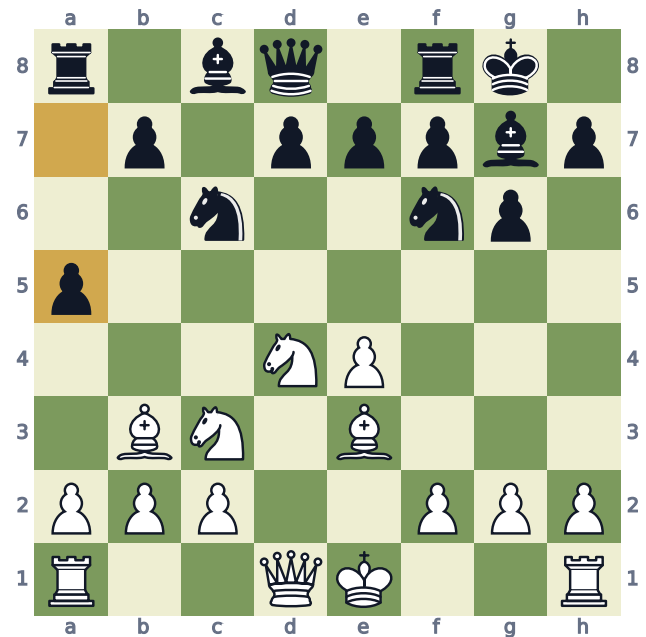
1. Be7 O-O 2. O-O f4 3. Nc6 Be3

COMPARISON 17 OF 36

Accelerated Dragon



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

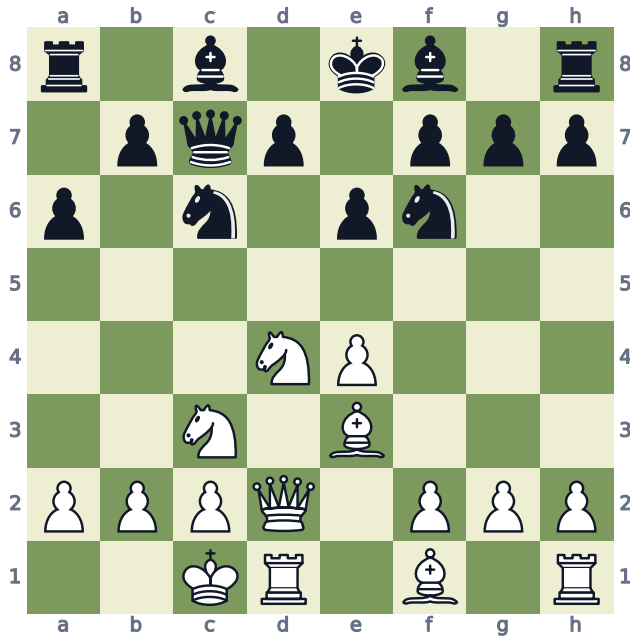
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

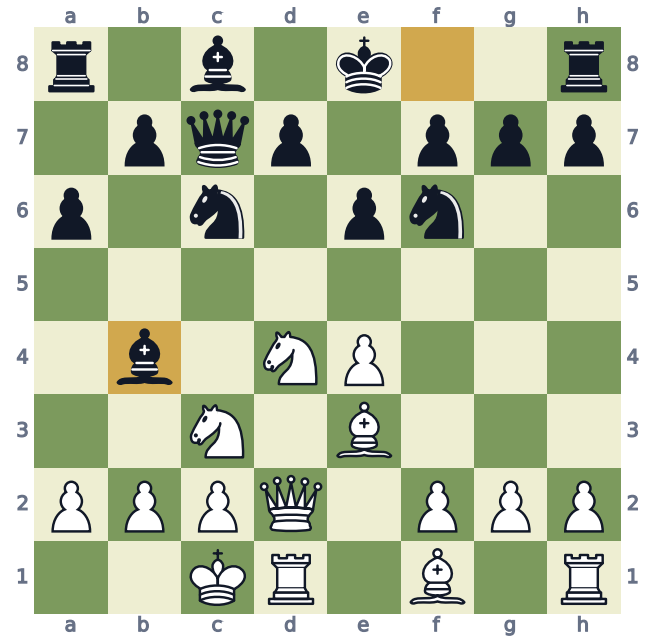
1. Be3 Nf6 2. Bc4 O-O 3. Bb3 a5

COMPARISON 18 OF 36

Sicilian Taimanov



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

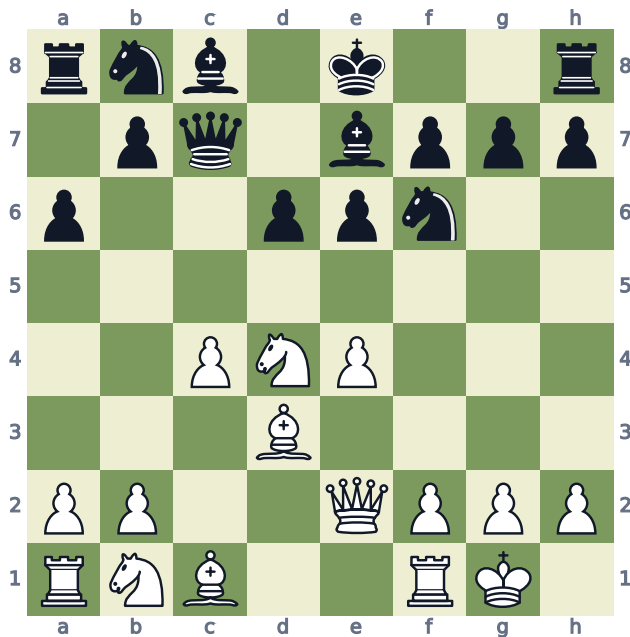
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

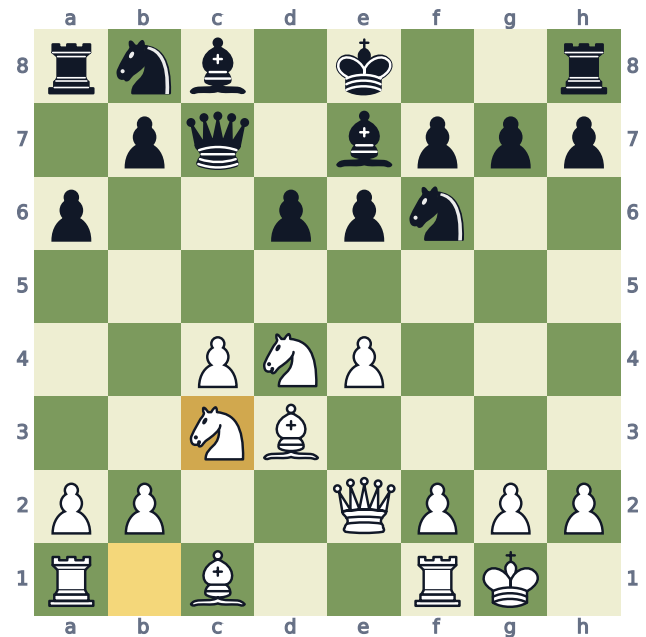
1. Be3 a6 2. Qd2 Nf6 3. O-O-O Bb4

COMPARISON 19 OF 36

Sicilian Kan



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

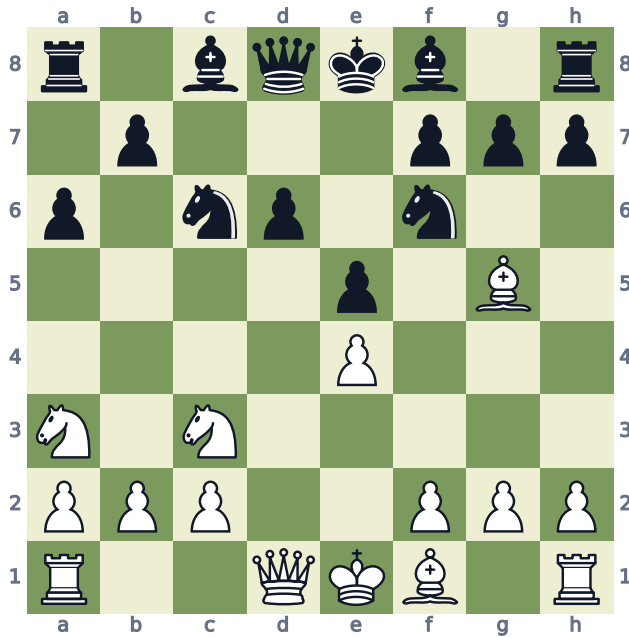
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

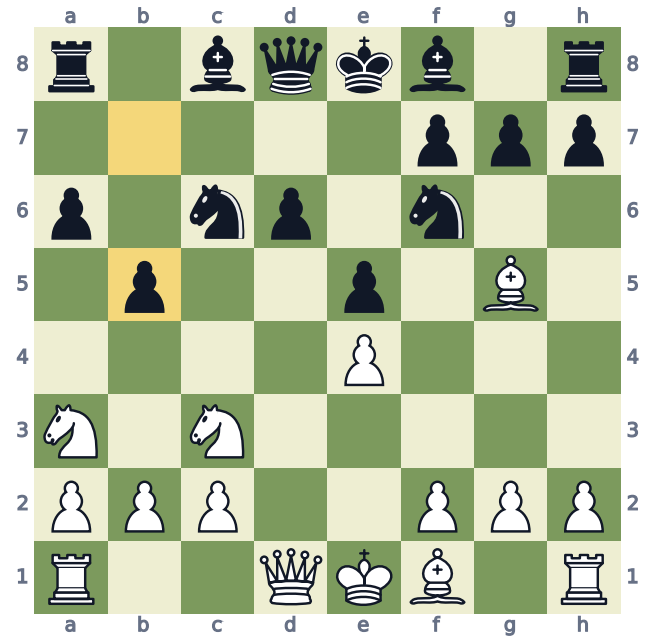
1. Nf6 Qe2 2. d6 c4 3. Be7 Nc3

COMPARISON 20 OF 36

Sicilian Sveshnikov



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

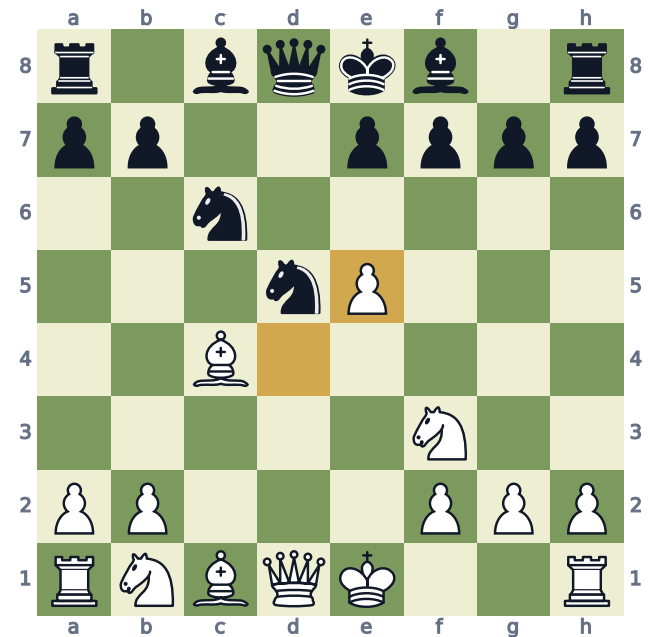
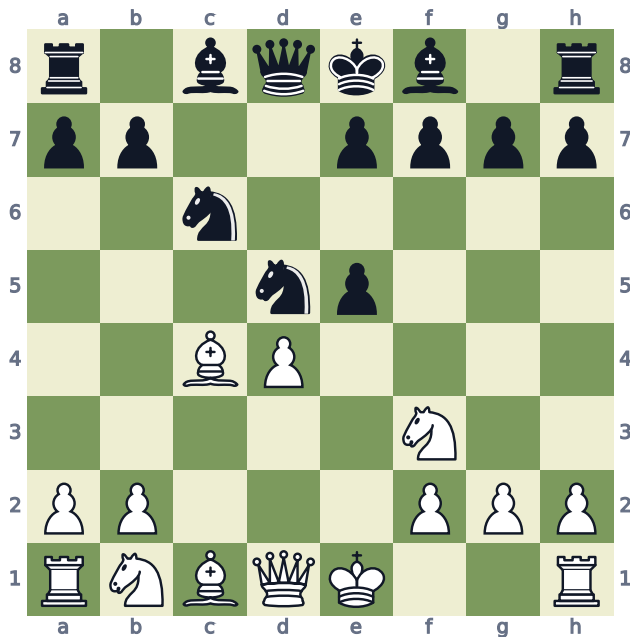
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

1. Ndb5 d6 2. Bg5 a6 3. Na3 b5

COMPARISON 21 OF 36

Sicilian Alapin



YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

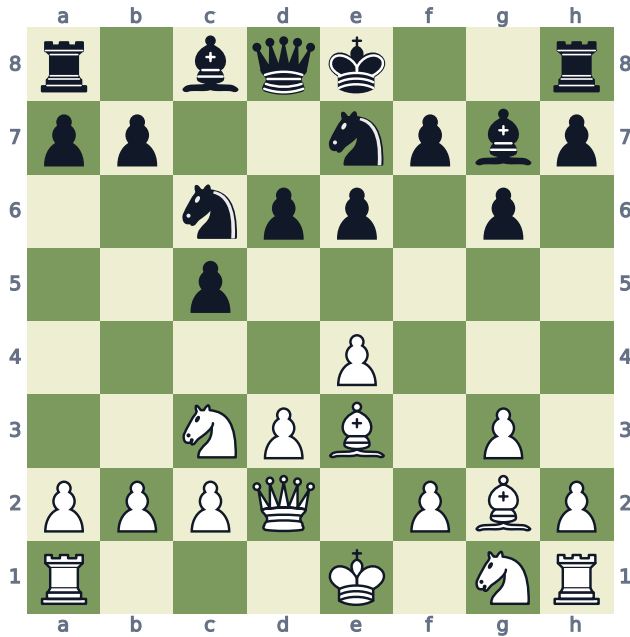
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

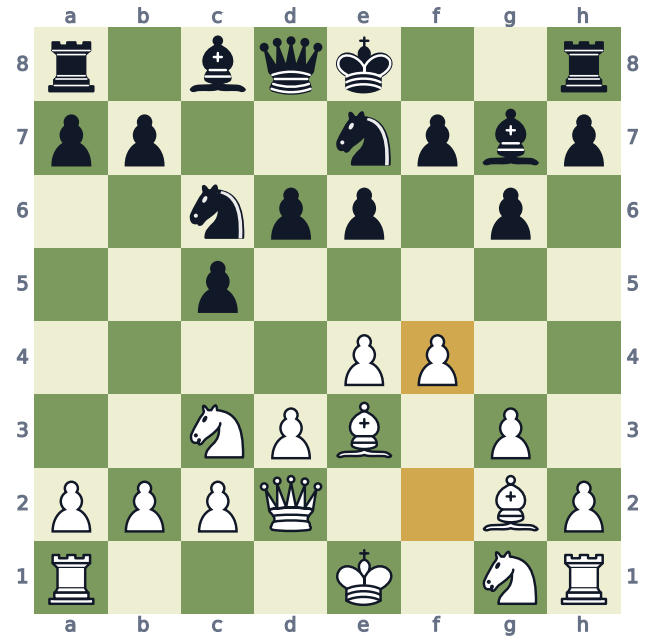
1. Nc6 cxd4 2. d6 Bc4 3. dxe5 dxe5

COMPARISON 22 OF 36

Closed Sicilian



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

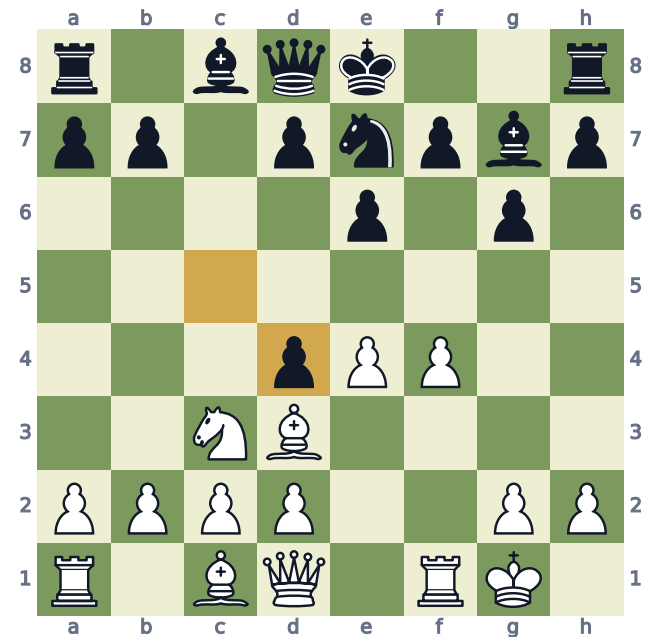
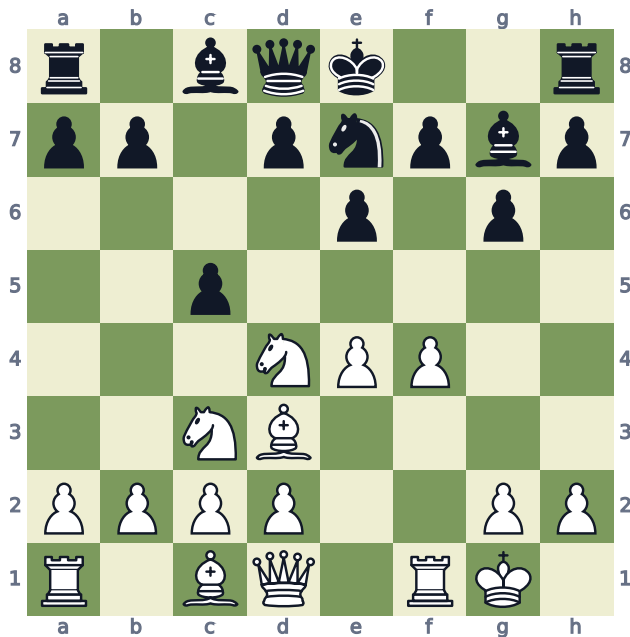
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

1. d6 Be3 2. e6 Qd2 3. Nge7 f4

COMPARISON 23 OF 36

Grand Prix Attack



YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

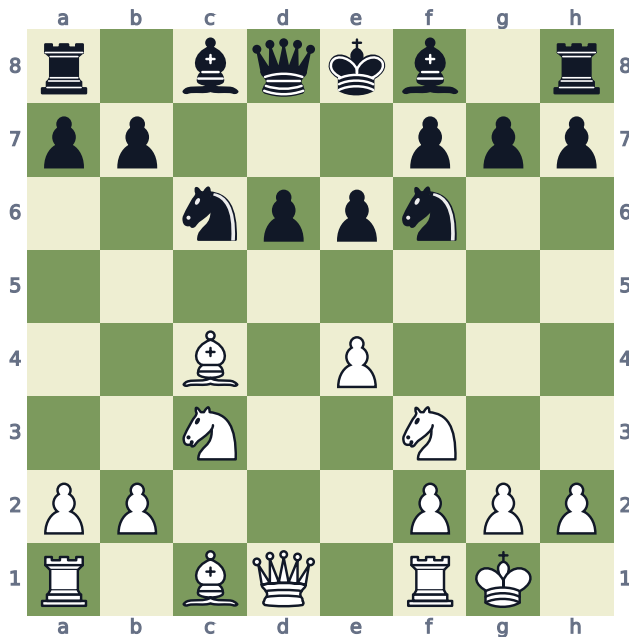
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

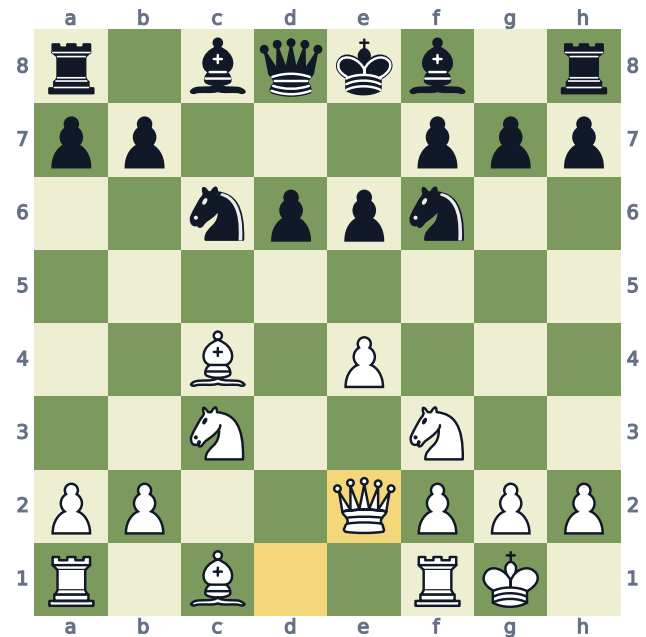
1. O-O e6 2. Bd3 Ne7 3. Nxd4 cxd4

COMPARISON 24 OF 36

Smith-Morra Gambit



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

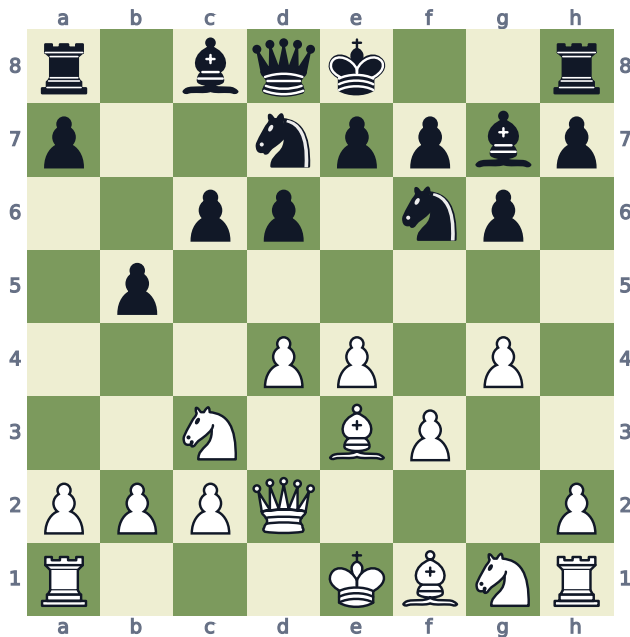
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

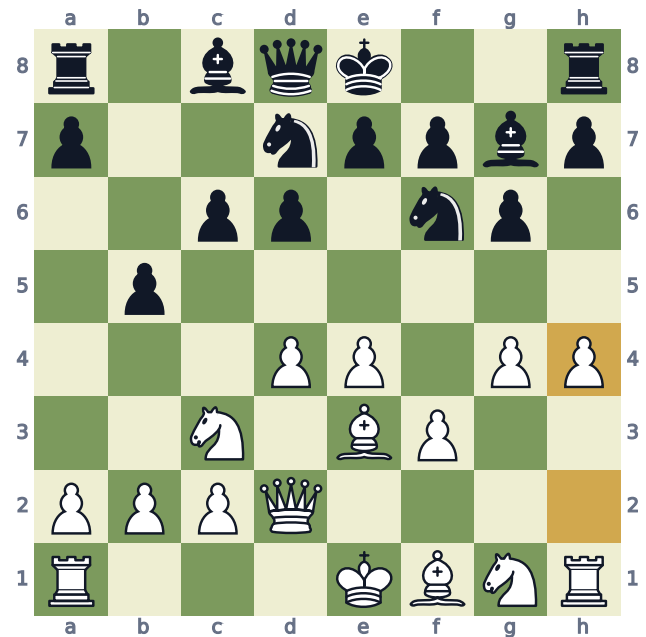
1. d6 Bc4 2. Nf6 O-O 3. e6 Qe2

COMPARISON 25 OF 36

Pirc Defense



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

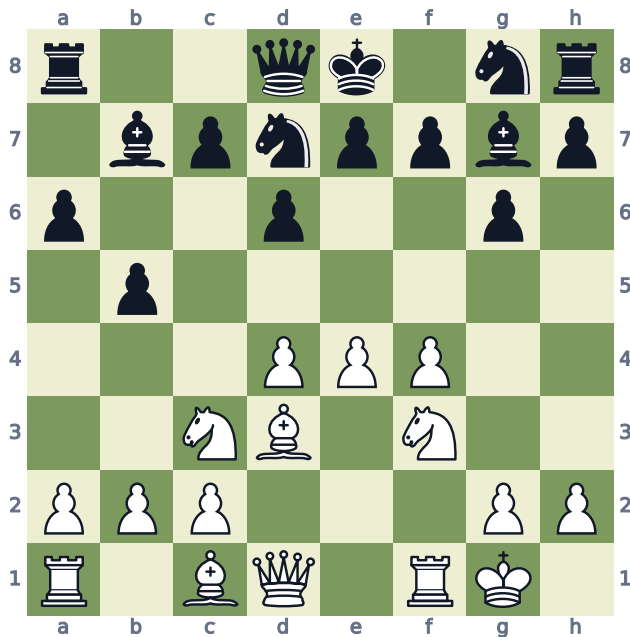
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

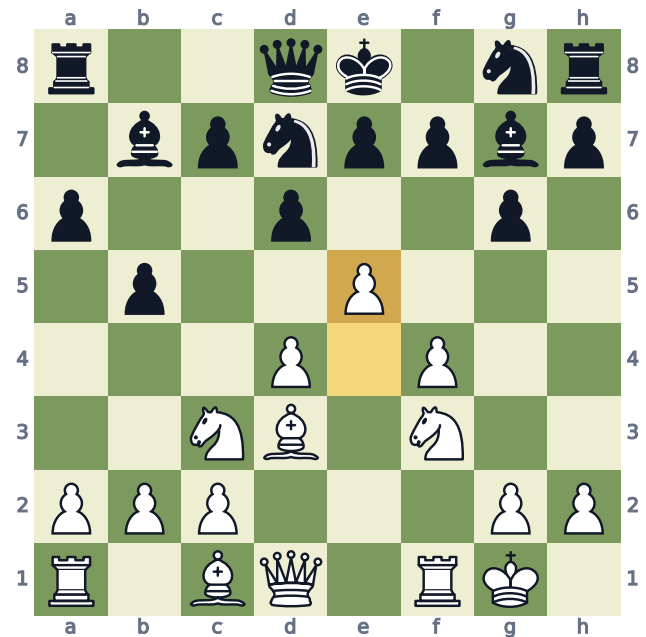
1. c6 f3 2. b5 g4 3. Nbd7 h4

COMPARISON 26 OF 36

Modern Defense



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

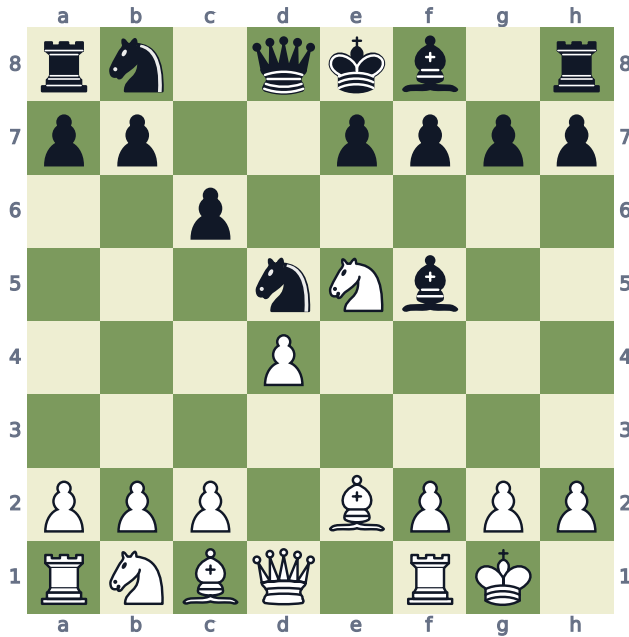
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

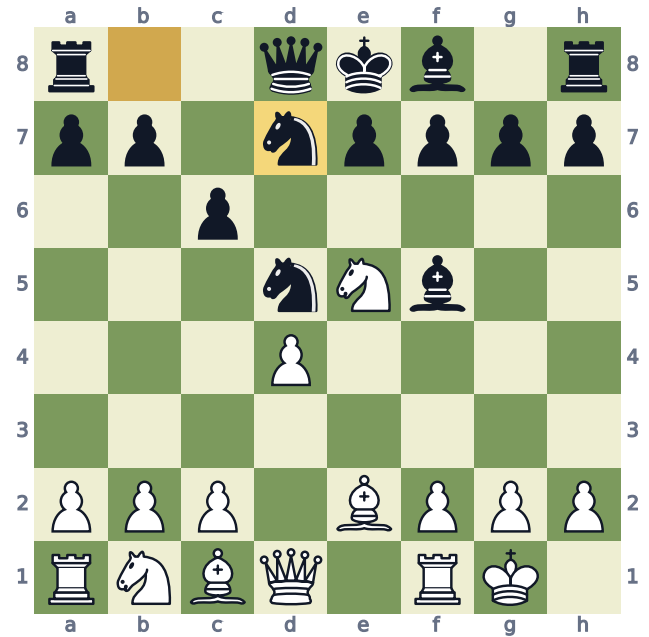
1. b5 Bd3 2. Nd7 O-O 3. Bb7 e5

COMPARISON 27 OF 36

Alekhine Defense



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

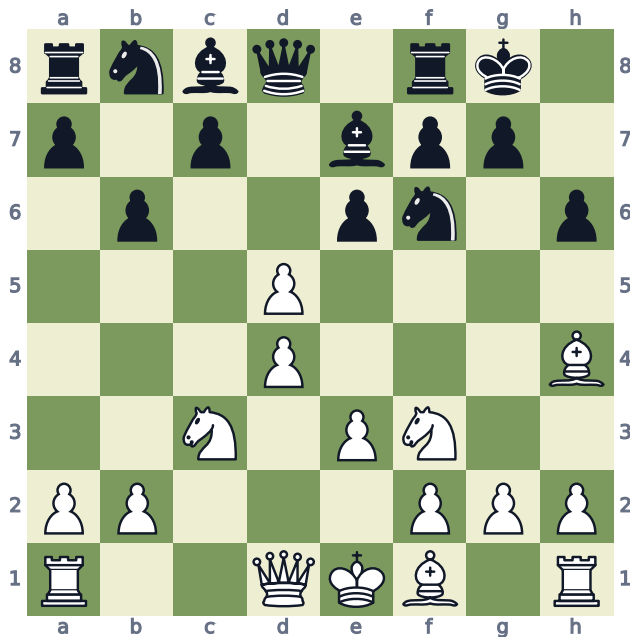
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

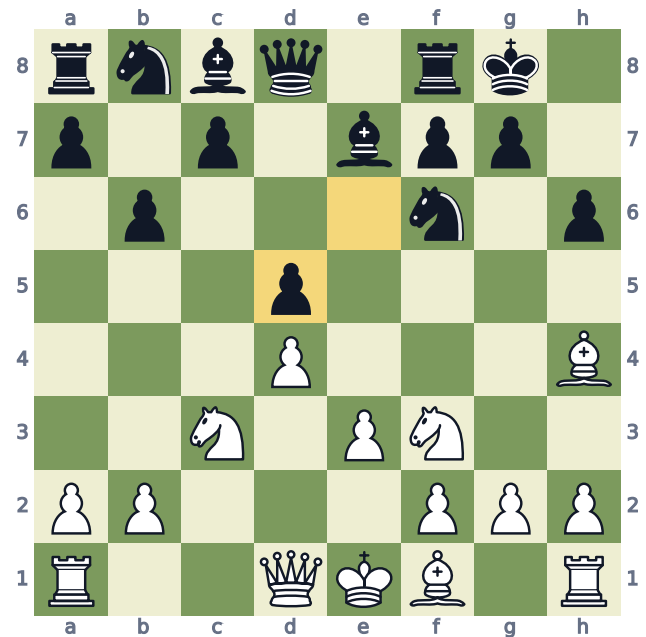
1. Nxe5 c6 2. Be2 Bf5 3. O-O Nd7

COMPARISON 28 OF 36

Queen's Gambit



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

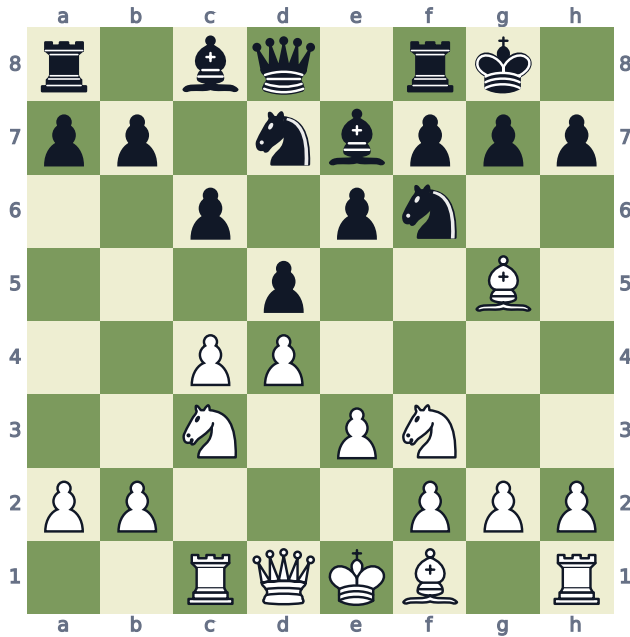
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

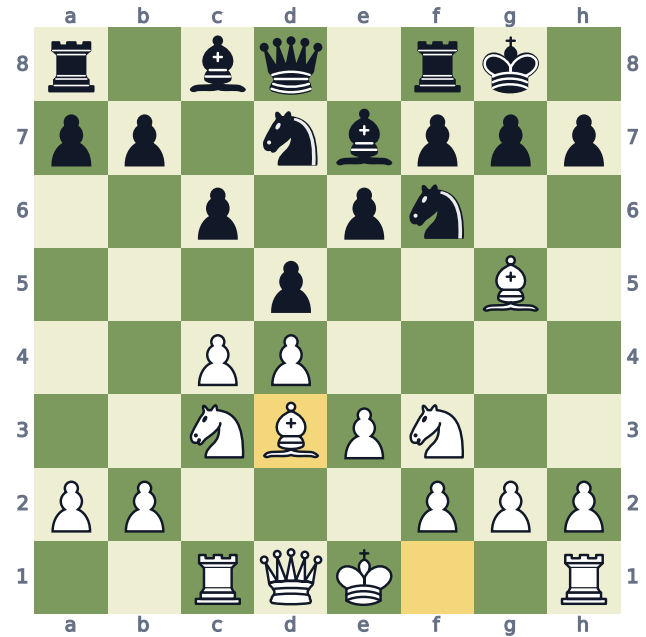
1. Nf3 h6 2. Bh4 b6 3. cxd5 exd5

COMPARISON 29 OF 36

Queen's Gambit Declined



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

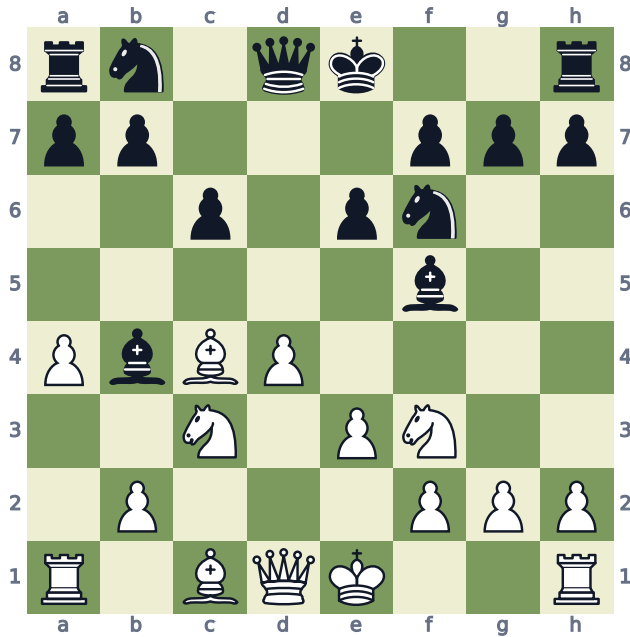
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

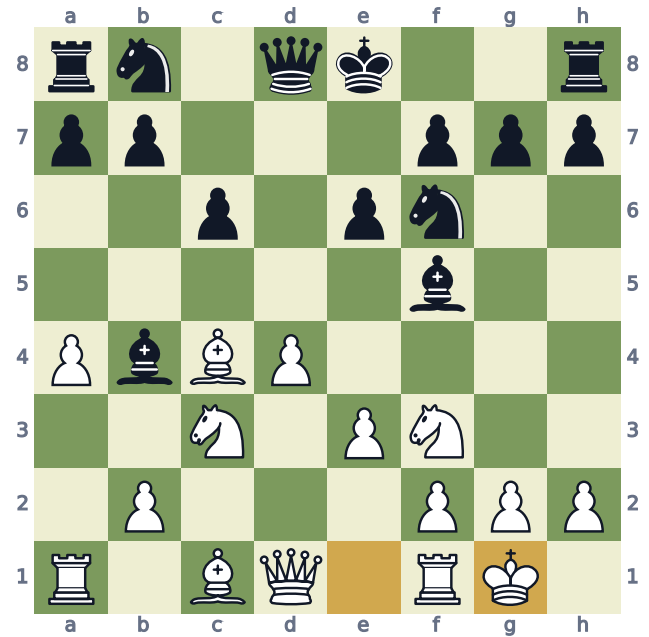
1. O-O Nf3 2. Nbd7 Rc1 3. c6 Bd3

COMPARISON 30 OF 36

Slav Defense



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

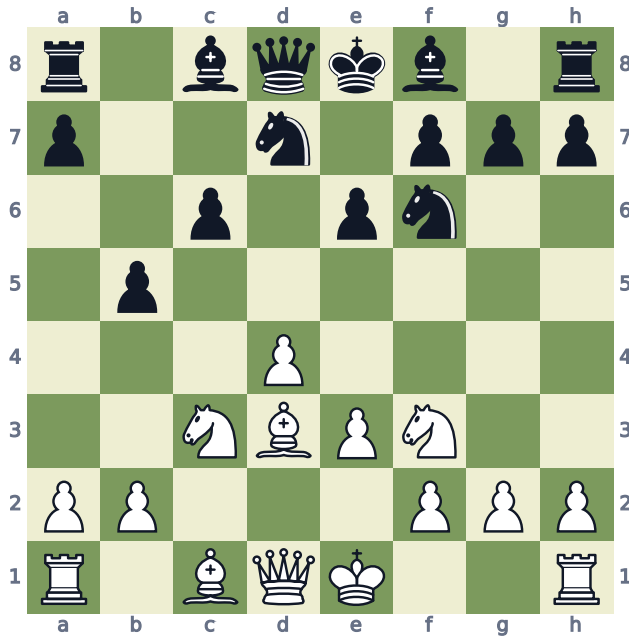
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

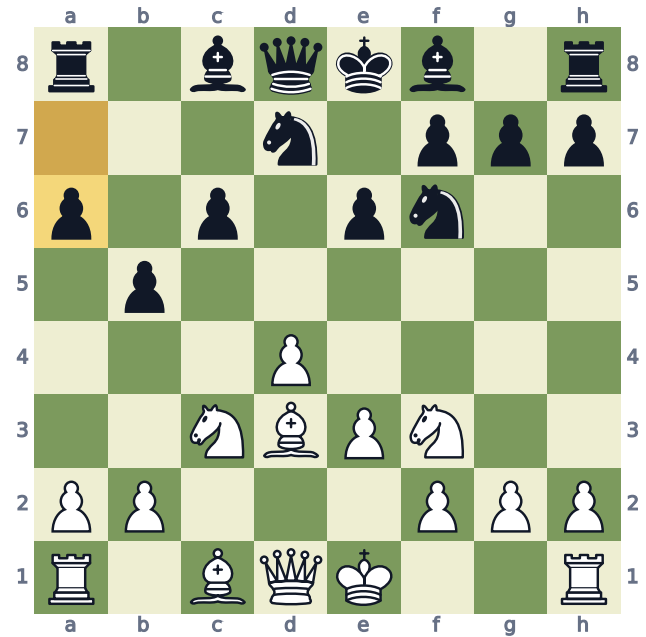
1. Bf5 e3 2. e6 Bxc4 3. Bb4 O-O

COMPARISON 31 OF 36

Semi-Slav Defense



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

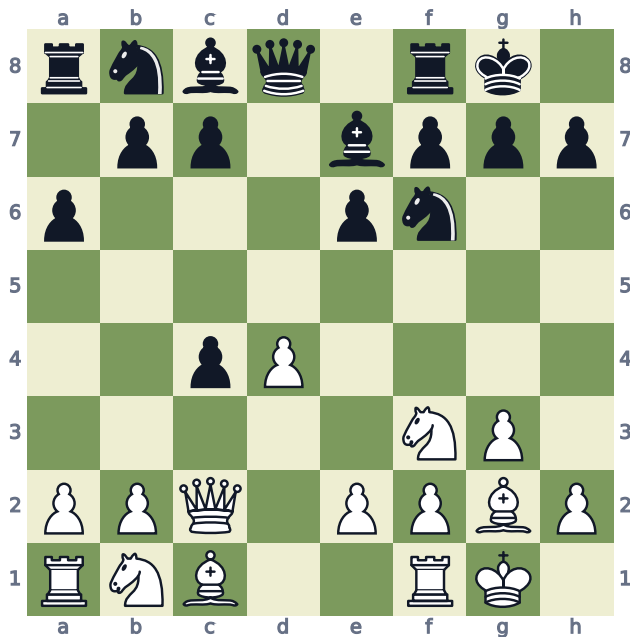
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

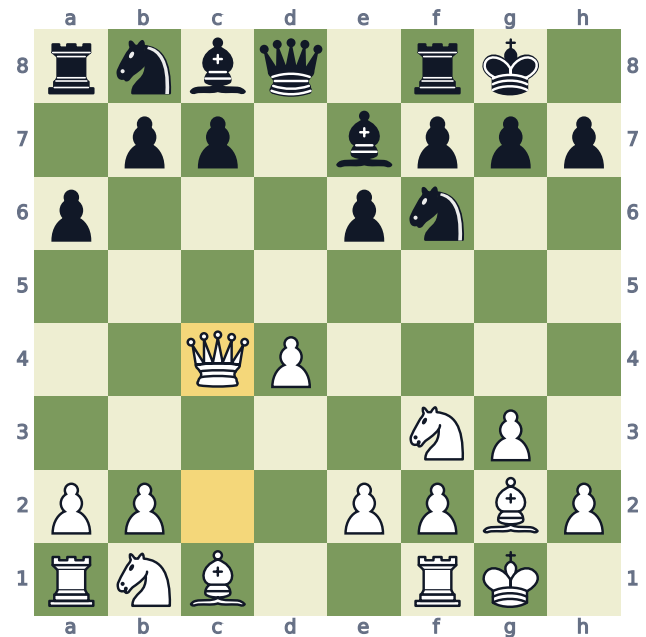
1. Bd3 dxc4 2. Bxc4 b5 3. Bd3 a6

COMPARISON 32 OF 36

Catalan Opening



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

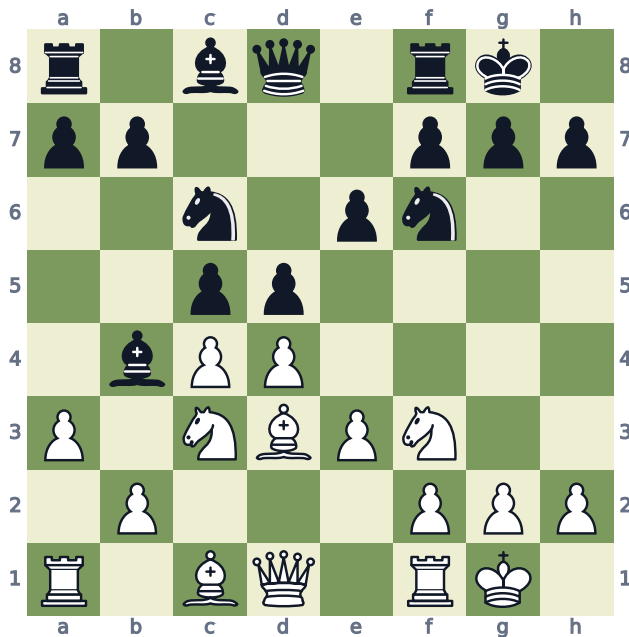
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

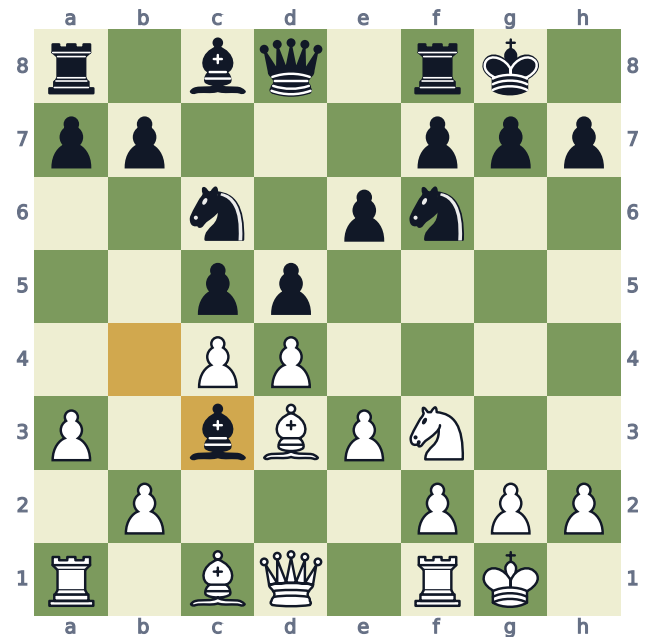
1. O-O O-O 2. dxc4 Qc2 3. a6 Qxc4

COMPARISON 33 OF 36

Nimzo-Indian Defense



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

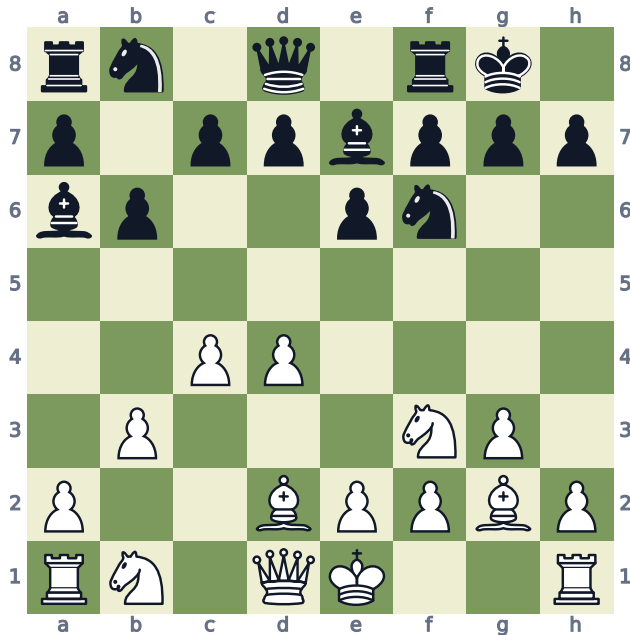
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

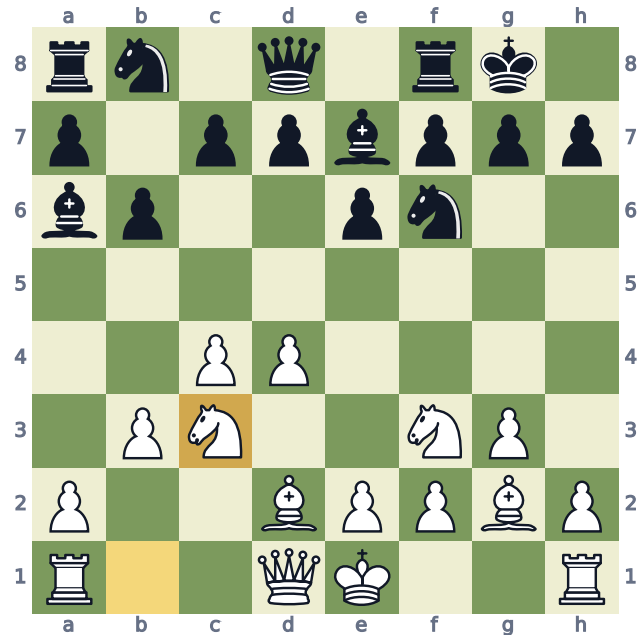
1. Nf3 c5 2. O-O Nc6 3. a3 Bxc3

COMPARISON 34 OF 36

Queen's Indian Defense



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

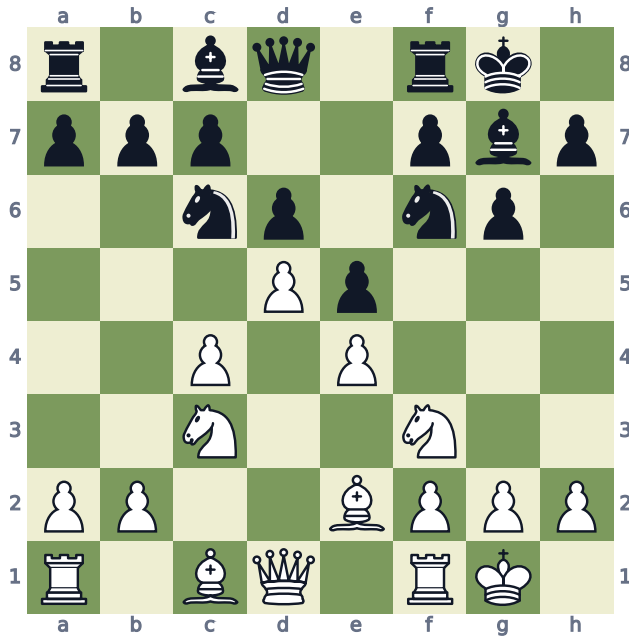
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

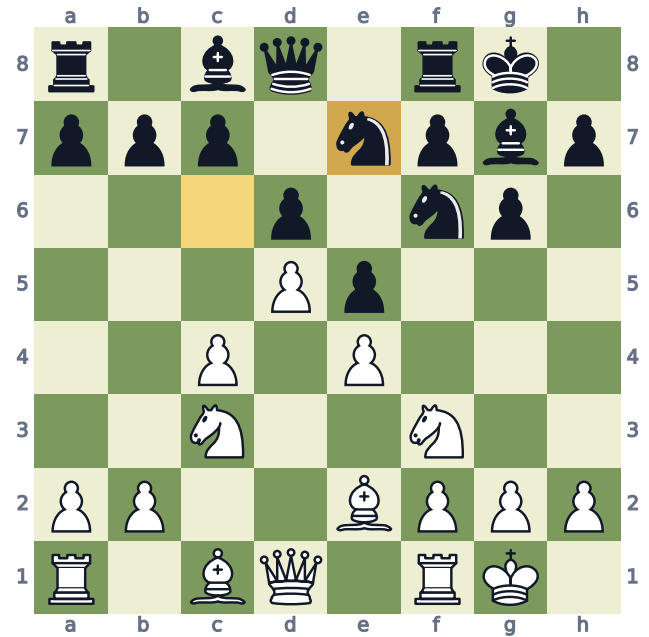
1. Bb4+ Bd2 2. Be7 Bg2 3. O-O Nc3

COMPARISON 35 OF 36

King's Indian Defense



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

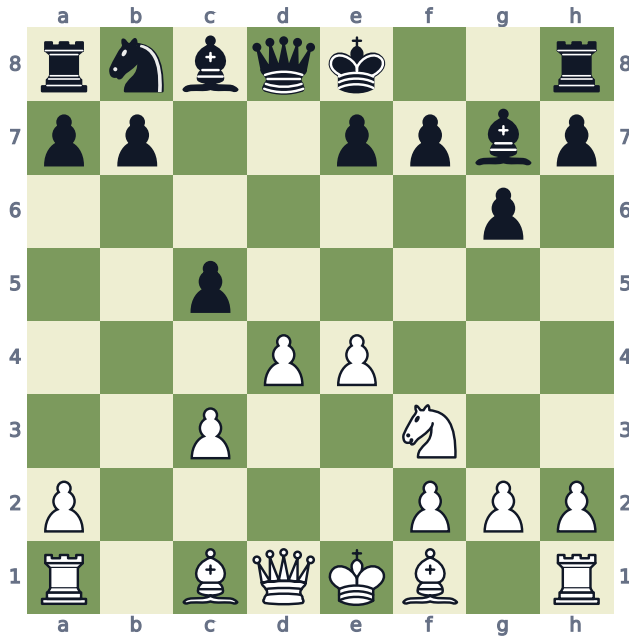
Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

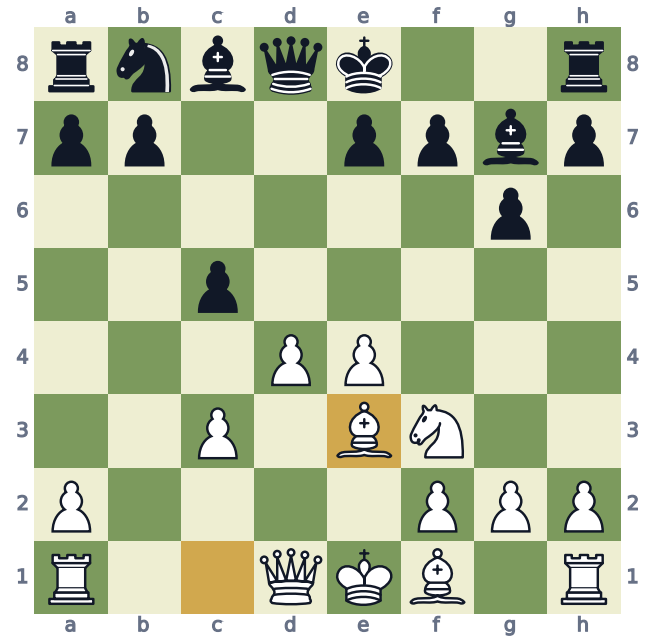
1. Be2 e5 2. O-O Nc6 3. d5 Ne7

COMPARISON 36 OF 36

Grunfeld Defense



BEFORE



AFTER

YOUR UPDATE INVENTORY

Without using the move notation, write: (1) what moved, (2) what was vacated, (3) new attacks, (4) lost defenses, (5) opened or closed lines, (6) pawn-structure change, (7) check or threat, and (8) the best forcing reply.

SEQUENCE

1. Nxc3 bxc3 2. Bg7 Nf3 3. c5 Be3

ANSWER SECTION

Change inventories

HOW TO GRADE

One point for each accurate consequence. Award no point for a vague statement such as 'the position changed.' The purpose is to update the internal board after every move.

ANSWER 01 OF 36

Italian Game

THE MOVE

Black's pawn moved from d7 to d5 (d5).

- The starting square d7 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- Because this was a pawn move, the newly controlled and permanently abandoned squares matter to every
- future plan.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences c4, e4.
- It is now White to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.
-

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Develop, build d4, castle, then attack. Typical break: White's d4 is the main freeing break; Black often answers with ...d5.

ANSWER 02 OF 36

Ruy Lopez

THE MOVE

Black's knight moved from c6 to b8 (Nb8).

- The starting square c6 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences a6, c6, d7.
- It is now White to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Pressure first, center second, tactics only when ready. Typical break: White wants d4; Black often seeks ...d5 after enough preparation.

ANSWER 03 OF 36

Scotch Game

THE MOVE

Black's bishop moved from c8 to a6 (Ba6).

- The starting square c8 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences c4, b5, b7, c8.
- It is now White to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Open center means every tempo matters. Typical break: Black's ...d6 or ...d5 challenges White's advanced e-pawn.

ANSWER 04 OF 36

Four Knights Game

THE MOVE

White's pawn moved from b2 to c3 (bxc3).

- The starting square b2 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- The move removed a bishop from c3, changing material and all of that piece's defensive duties.
- Because this was a pawn move, the newly controlled and permanently abandoned squares matter to every
- future plan.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences b4, d4.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.
-

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Complete development, then break symmetry. Typical break: The d-pawn break by either side determines whether the game stays quiet.

ANSWER 05 OF 36

Vienna Game

THE MOVE

White's bishop moved from f1 to d3 (Bd3).

- The starting square f1 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences f1, c2, e2, c4, e4, b5, a6.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Flank pressure works because the center is supported. Typical break: White's f4 is the signature break; Black's ...d5 is the principled reply.

ANSWER 06 OF 36

King's Gambit

THE MOVE

Black's knight moved from f6 to h5 (Nh5).

- The starting square f6 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences g3, f4, f6, g7.
- It is now White to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: The pawn is an investment in time, not a debt. Typical break: White's d4 restores central control; Black's ...d5 challenges the attacking setup.

ANSWER 07 OF 36

Petrov Defense

THE MOVE

White's knight moved from b1 to c3 (Nc3).

- The starting square b1 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences b1, d1, a2, e2, a4, e4, b5, d5.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Challenge, chase, recover - in that order. Typical break: c4 challenges Black's d5 anchor; ...c6 reinforces or prepares a later queenside expansion.

ANSWER 08 OF 36

Philidor Defense

THE MOVE

White's pawn moved from a2 to a4 (a4).

- The starting square a2 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- Because this was a pawn move, the newly controlled and permanently abandoned squares matter to every
- future plan.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences b5.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.
-

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Solid first, free the position second. Typical break: Black needs ...d5 or sometimes ...c6 and ...b5 to avoid permanent congestion.

ANSWER 09 OF 36

Scandinavian Defense

THE MOVE

Black's pawn moved from e7 to e6 (e6).

- The starting square e7 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- Because this was a pawn move, the newly controlled and permanently abandoned squares matter to every
- future plan.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences d5, f5.
- It is now White to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.
-

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Take the free development, not a pawn-chasing detour. Typical break: Black's ...c5 challenges d4; White may use d5 if development supports the advance.

ANSWER 10 OF 36

French Defense

THE MOVE

White's knight moved from f3 to d4 (Nxd4).

- The starting square f3 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- The move removed a pawn from d4, changing material and all of that piece's defensive duties.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences c2, e2, b3, f3, b5, f5, c6, e6.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.
-

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Pawn chains point toward the wing of attack. Typical break: ...c5 is essential; ...f6 is the second lever against White's center.

ANSWER 11 OF 36

Caro-Kann Defense

THE MOVE

White's knight moved from f3 to d4 (Nxd4).

- The starting square f3 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- The move removed a pawn from d4, changing material and all of that piece's defensive duties.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences c2, e2, b3, f3, b5, f5, c6, e6.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Bishop out, center challenged, structure sound. Typical break: ...c5 is the main equalizing lever; ...f6 may attack e5 later.

ANSWER 12 OF 36

Open Sicilian

THE MOVE

White's king moved from e1 to c1 (O-O-O).

- The starting square e1 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- Castling changed king safety and rook activity in one move.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences b1, d1, b2, c2, d2.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: White gets time; Black gets structure and counterplay. Typical break: White often uses f4-f5; Black often uses ...d5 or ...b5-b4.

ANSWER 13 OF 36

Sicilian Najdorf

THE MOVE

White's queen moved from d1 to d2 (Qd2).

- The starting square d1 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences c1, d1, e1, c2, e2, f2, g2, c3.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Control b5, expand with ...b5, fight for d5. Typical break: ...b5-b4 is thematic; White often uses g4-g5 or f4-f5.

ANSWER 14 OF 36

Sicilian Dragon

THE MOVE

White's bishop moved from f1 to c4 (Bc4).

- The starting square f1 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences f1, a2, e2, b3, d3, b5, d5, a6.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: The g7-bishop and c-file power Black's attack. Typical break: White's h4-h5 and Black's ...b5 are the race-defining breaks.

ANSWER 15 OF 36

Classical Sicilian

THE MOVE

White's pawn moved from f2 to f4 (f4).

- The starting square f2 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- Because this was a pawn move, the newly controlled and permanently abandoned squares matter to every
- future plan.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences e5, g5.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.
-

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Natural development keeps Black's options open. Typical break: White's f5 challenges e6; Black's ...d5 is the cleanest freeing break.

ANSWER 16 OF 36

Sicilian Scheveningen

THE MOVE

White's bishop moved from c1 to e3 (Be3).

- The starting square c1 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences c1, g1, d2, f2, d4, f4.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Compact center, flexible counterpunch. Typical break: White's f5 and Black's ...d5 or ...b5 are the critical levers.

ANSWER 17 OF 36

Accelerated Dragon

THE MOVE

Black's pawn moved from a7 to a5 (a5).

- The starting square a7 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- Because this was a pawn move, the newly controlled and permanently abandoned squares matter to every
- future plan.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences b4.
- It is now White to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.
-

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: No ...d6 means ...d5 is always in the room. Typical break: ...d5 is the opening's central question; White's c4 can restrain it.

ANSWER 18 OF 36

Sicilian Taimanov

THE MOVE

Black's bishop moved from f8 to b4 (Bb4).

- The starting square f8 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences a3, c3, a5, c5, d6, e7, f8.
- It is now White to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Queen on c7 makes e5, c3, and h2 matter. Typical break: Black's ...d5 is ideal; ...b5 creates the usual queenside space.

ANSWER 19 OF 36

Sicilian Kan

THE MOVE

White's knight moved from b1 to c3 (Nc3).

- The starting square b1 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences b1, d1, a2, e2, a4, e4, b5, d5.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Delay the knight, keep every structure available. Typical break: ...b5 is thematic; ...d5 is the freeing central goal.

ANSWER 20 OF 36

Sicilian Sveshnikov

THE MOVE

Black's pawn moved from b7 to b5 (b5).

- The starting square b7 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- Because this was a pawn move, the newly controlled and permanently abandoned squares matter to every
- future plan.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences a4, c4.
- It is now White to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.
-

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Static weaknesses are the price of dynamic time. Typical break: ...f5 energizes Black's kingside; White often uses c3 and Nc2-e3-d5.

ANSWER 21 OF 36

Sicilian Alapin

THE MOVE

White's pawn moved from d4 to e5 (dxe5).

- The starting square d4 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- The move removed a pawn from e5, changing material and all of that piece's defensive duties.
- Because this was a pawn move, the newly controlled and permanently abandoned squares matter to every future plan.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences d6, f6.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.
-

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Build d4, then defend the center with pieces. Typical break: Black's ...d5 or ...d6 attacks the center; White may advance e5 for space.

ANSWER 22 OF 36

Closed Sicilian

THE MOVE

White's pawn moved from f2 to f4 (f4).

- The starting square f2 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- Because this was a pawn move, the newly controlled and permanently abandoned squares matter to every
- future plan.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences e5, g5.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.
-

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Closed center buys time - use it to finish the setup. Typical break: White's f5 and Black's ...b5 create the two-wing race.

ANSWER 23 OF 36

Grand Prix Attack

THE MOVE

Black's pawn moved from c5 to d4 (cxd4).

- The starting square c5 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- The move removed a knight from d4, changing material and all of that piece's defensive duties.
- Because this was a pawn move, the newly controlled and permanently abandoned squares matter to every future plan.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences c3, e3.
- It is now White to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.
-

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Castle first, aim at h7, calculate ...d5. Typical break: White's f5 is thematic; Black's ...d5 is the central antidote.

ANSWER 24 OF 36

Smith-Morra Gambit

THE MOVE

White's queen moved from d1 to e2 (Qe2).

- The starting square d1 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences d1, e1, f1, b2, c2, d2, f2, d3.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Development and open files are the compensation. Typical break: White may use e5; Black often seeks ...d5 to neutralize the initiative.

ANSWER 25 OF 36

Pirc Defense

THE MOVE

White's pawn moved from h2 to h4 (h4).

- The starting square h2 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- Because this was a pawn move, the newly controlled and permanently abandoned squares matter to every
- future plan.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences g5.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.
-

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Invite the center, then hit its base. Typical break: Black's ...e5 or ...c5 challenges the center; White often uses f4-f5 or h4-h5.

ANSWER 26 OF 36

Modern Defense

THE MOVE

White's pawn moved from e4 to e5 (e5).

- The starting square e4 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- Because this was a pawn move, the newly controlled and permanently abandoned squares matter to every
- future plan.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences d6, f6.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.
-

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Delay commitment, not development forever. Typical break: ...c5 and ...e5 are Black's key choices; White's e5 can gain space and time.

ANSWER 27 OF 36

Alekhine Defense

THE MOVE

Black's knight moved from b8 to d7 (Nd7).

- The starting square b8 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences c5, e5, b6, f6, b8, f8.
- It is now White to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Space is useful only when pieces can use it. Typical break: ...d6 is the first challenge; ...c5 adds pressure to d4.

ANSWER 28 OF 36

Queen's Gambit

THE MOVE

Black's pawn moved from e6 to d5 (exd5).

- The starting square e6 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- The move removed a pawn from d5, changing material and all of that piece's defensive duties.
- Because this was a pawn move, the newly controlled and permanently abandoned squares matter to every future plan.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences c4, e4.
- It is now White to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.
-

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: The c-pawn asks Black's d-pawn a structural question. Typical break: White's cxd5 may create a Carlsbad structure; Black wants ...c5.

ANSWER 29 OF 36

Queen's Gambit Declined

THE MOVE

White's bishop moved from f1 to d3 (Bd3).

- The starting square f1 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences b1, f1, c2, e2, c4, e4, f5, g6.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Support the center, then free the bishop. Typical break: ...c5 is the standard freeing break; ...e5 is possible with preparation.

ANSWER 30 OF 36

Slav Defense

THE MOVE

White's king moved from e1 to g1 (O-O).

- The starting square e1 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- Castling changed king safety and rook activity in one move.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences f1, h1, f2, g2, h2.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Support d5 without locking in the bishop. Typical break: Black's ...c5 or ...e5 is the long-term freeing goal.

ANSWER 31 OF 36

Semi-Slav Defense

THE MOVE

Black's pawn moved from a7 to a6 (a6).

- The starting square a7 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- Because this was a pawn move, the newly controlled and permanently abandoned squares matter to every
- future plan.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences b5.
- It is now White to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.
-

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Compact shell, then a timed central explosion. Typical break: ...c5 and ...e5 are the central liberating breaks.

ANSWER 32 OF 36

Catalan Opening

THE MOVE

White's queen moved from c2 to c4 (Qxc4).

- The starting square c2 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- The move removed a pawn from c4, changing material and all of that piece's defensive duties.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences c1, a2, c2, e2, b3, c3, d3, a4.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: The bishop is the opening's long-range engine. Typical break: White may use e4; Black's ...c5 challenges the center.

ANSWER 33 OF 36

Nimzo-Indian Defense

THE MOVE

Black's bishop moved from b4 to c3 (Bxc3).

- The starting square b4 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- The move removed a knight from c3, changing material and all of that piece's defensive duties.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences e1, b2, d2, b4, d4, a5.
- It is now White to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Pin the knight, control e4, choose the right structure. Typical break: ...c5 and ...d5 are Black's central challenges; White often uses e4.

ANSWER 34 OF 36

Queen's Indian Defense

THE MOVE

White's knight moved from b1 to c3 (Nc3).

- The starting square b1 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences b1, d1, a2, e2, a4, e4, b5, d5.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: The b7-bishop points at e4 before it points at the king. Typical break: ...c5 is a common challenge; White may use d5 or e4 depending on timing.

ANSWER 35 OF 36

King's Indian Defense

THE MOVE

Black's knight moved from c6 to e7 (Ne7).

- The starting square c6 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences d5, f5, c6, g6, c8, g8.
- It is now White to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Follow the pawn-chain arrows: White queenside, Black kingside. Typical break: White's c5 and Black's ...f5 define the two-wing race.

ANSWER 36 OF 36

Grunfeld Defense

THE MOVE

White's bishop moved from c1 to e3 (Be3).

- The starting square c1 is now vacant, so every rook, bishop, or queen line through it must be recalculated.
- From its new square the moved piece attacks or influences c1, d2, f2, d4, f4, g5, h6.
- It is now Black to move; begin with that side's checks, captures, and direct threats.

STRATEGIC CONTINUATION

Memory cue: Build the center, then prove it can survive pressure. Typical break: ...c5 is the main strike; ...e5 may add a second challenge.

REVIEW

The update habit

1

Replay a slow game and pause after every move to name three consequences.

2

Mark the first move where a line opened and you failed to update its geometry.

3

Collect five blunders caused by a moved defender or newly loose piece.

4

Use the question 'What changed?' before candidate generation for ten games.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Repeat missed positions tomorrow, then after 3, 7, 14, and 30 days. Remove a position only after two correct solutions with a complete explanation.